

SS2 NIGERIAN HISTORY LESSON NOTES

FIRST TERM

WEEK 1: THE SOKOTO CALIPHATE



1.1 Introduction: The Pre-Jihad Context in Hausaland

Before 1804, the Hausaland region (in modern-day Northern Nigeria) was not a single, unified country. It was comprised of several independent and often rival city-states, known as the *Hausa Bakwai* (the "seven true" Hausa states: Daura, Kano, Katsina, Zaria, Rano, Gobir, and Biram) and the *Banza Bakwai* (the "seven "illegitimate" states).

These states were politically independent, ruled by kings (Sarkis), and had complex systems of government. While Islam had been in Hausaland for centuries (introduced by traders and clerics from Mali and Songhai), it was often practiced in a "syncretic" way. This means traditional Hausa beliefs (Bori spirit possession, animism) were mixed with Islamic practices.

The rulers (Sarkis) often claimed to be Muslim but continued to engage in practices seen as "pagan" by strict reformers. They also imposed heavy, arbitrary taxes on the people, conscripted men into their armies, and were seen by many as corrupt and unjust.

1.2 Origin and Rise of the Caliphate: Usman dan Fodio

The Sokoto Caliphate was born out of a religious, social, and political reform movement known as the 1804 Jihad. The central figure of this movement was **Shehu Usman dan Fodio**.

- **Who was Usman dan Fodio?**

- He was a Fulani scholar (cleric) and preacher, born in 1754 in the Hausa state of Gobir.
- He was from the *Toronkawa* clan of Fulani, a group known for its Islamic scholarship.
- He was a member of the Qadiriyya Sufi brotherhood.
- He spent his early life as an itinerant preacher, traveling through Gobir, Kebbi, and Zamfara, teaching a "purified" version of Islam based strictly on the Qur'an and Sunnah.

- **His Preaching and Followers:**

- Usman dan Fodio's preaching was revolutionary. He called for a *tajdid* (renewal) of Islam.
- He attacked the Hausa rulers for their:
 1. **Religious Syncretism:** Mixing Islam with pagan rituals.
 2. **Unjust Rule:** Imposing oppressive taxes (like the *jangali* or cattle tax on the Fulani), seizing property, and conscripting subjects.
 3. **Corruption:** The judicial system was corrupt, and rulers lived in luxury while the common people (*talakawa*) suffered.
 4. **Enslavement of Muslims:** A practice forbidden by Islamic law.
- His message attracted a massive following, known as the *jama'a* (community). This group included not just his fellow Fulani (especially the pastoralists who felt marginalized) but also many disgruntled Hausa commoners.

1.3 The 1804 Jihad: Causes and Course

The "jihad" (which translates to "struggle," in this context a "holy war") was the armed conflict that established the Caliphate.

- **Immediate Trigger:**

- The *Sarkin Gobir*, Yunfa (a former student of dan Fodio), grew fearful of Usman's rising popularity and influence. He saw the *jama'a* as a "state within a state."
- Yunfa attempted to assassinate Usman dan Fodio and began persecuting his followers.
- In 1804, Usman dan Fodio and his followers fled from their home in Degel. This migration is known as the *Hijra* (mirroring the Prophet Muhammad's migration from Mecca to Medina).
- They settled at a place called Gudu. From here, Usman dan Fodio formally declared a jihad against Yunfa and the other Hausa rulers, whom he now labeled as *kafir* (unbelievers).

- **Fundamental Causes of the Jihad:**

1. **Religious:** The primary stated cause. To purify Islam, eradicate syncretic practices, and establish a state governed by *Shari'a* (Islamic Law).
2. **Political:** The desire to overthrow the corrupt, oppressive, and "un-Islamic" Hausa ruling dynasties. The *jama'a* wanted a just government.
3. **Social/Economic:** The deep-seated grievances of the common people (both Hausa *talakawa* and Fulani pastoralists) against the ruling aristocracy. This included high taxes, land appropriation, and social injustice. The Fulani, in particular, resented the *jangali* (cattle tax).

- **Course of the War:**

- Usman dan Fodio was the spiritual leader (*Amir al-Mu'minin* - Commander of the Faithful). He did not fight in battles himself.

- He gave "flags" (*tuta*) to his most trusted followers (flag-bearers), authorizing them to carry the jihad to other Hausa states.
- His key commanders included his brother, **Abdullahi of Gwandu**, and his son, **Muhammadu Bello**.
- The jihadists' forces, though often poorly armed, were highly motivated. They successfully defeated the larger, but disunited, armies of the Hausa states.
- By 1808, Gobir had fallen. By 1810, Kano, Katsina, Zaria, and other states were conquered. The old Hausa dynasties were overthrown and replaced by Fulani Emirs.

1.4 Effects of the Jihad

(Note: This will be covered in greater detail in Week 3)

1. **Political:** The creation of a single, vast empire (the Sokoto Caliphate), which replaced the fragmented Hausa states.
2. **Religious:** The widespread purification and expansion of Islam.
3. **Social:** The emergence of a new ruling class (the Fulani aristocracy) and the eventual creation of a "Hausa-Fulani" identity.
4. **Intellectual:** A major boom in Islamic scholarship, with Sokoto and Gwandu becoming centers of learning.

Evaluation

1. What does the term "syncretism" mean in the context of pre-jihad Hausaland?
2. Who was Usman dan Fodio, and what was his ethnic background?
3. Explain the *Hijra* of 1804 and why it was a turning point.
4. List the three main categories of causes for the Sokoto Jihad.
5. Who were Usman dan Fodio's two most important commanders, who were also his family members?

Assignment

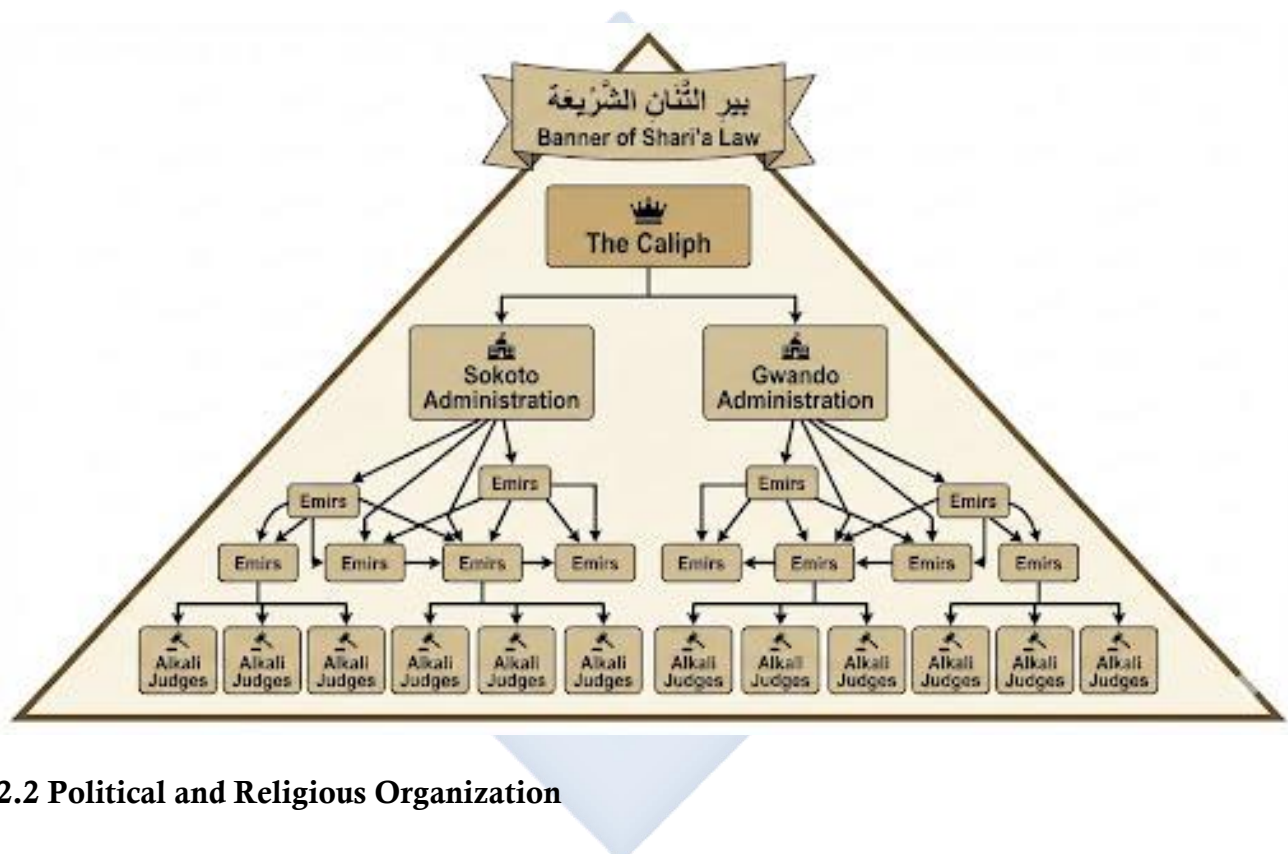
1. In a detailed paragraph, describe the social, political, and religious grievances that Usman dan Fodio preached against.
2. "The Sokoto Jihad was purely a religious movement." Do you agree or disagree? Provide three points to support your answer.



WEEK 2: THE ADMINISTRATION OF THE CALIPHATE

2.1 Introduction

The Sokoto CaliphATE, once established, was not just a loose collection of states. It was a sophisticated, organized, and centrally-governed empire. At its peak, it was the largest and most populous state in West Africa. Its administration was a *theocracy*, meaning the government was based on religious law (Shari'a).



2.2 Political and Religious Organization

- **The Caliph (Sultan of Sokoto):**
 - The supreme head of the Caliphate was the *Amir al-Mu'minin* (Commander of the Faithful), also known as the Caliph or, later, the Sultan of Sokoto.
 - Usman dan Fodio was the first Caliph. After his retirement, his son **Muhammadu Bello** (who built the city of Sokoto as the capital) succeeded him.
 - The Caliph held both supreme political and religious authority. He was the final court of appeal and was responsible for appointing Emirs.

- **The Sokoto-Gwandu Duality:**

- In 1812, even before the war was fully over, Usman dan Fodio retired from active administration.
- He divided the Caliphate into two major administrative zones:
 1. **The Eastern Zone:** Administered by his son, **Muhammadu Bello**, from Sokoto. This included major emirates like Kano, Katsina, and Zaria.
 2. **The Western Zone:** Administered by his brother, **Abdullahi**, from Gwandu. This included emirates like Nupe and Ilorin.
- This was *not* a split. The Emir of Gwandu still owed allegiance to the Caliph in Sokoto, but he had significant autonomy in managing the western emirates.

- **The Waziri (Vizier):**

- The Caliph's chief administrator and advisor, similar to a Prime Minister.
- The *Waziri* of Sokoto was the most powerful official after the Caliph, responsible for the day-to-day running of the empire, diplomacy, and managing relations with the emirs.

2.3 The Emirate System

The Caliphate was composed of numerous emirates (the former Hausa states and newly conquered territories). Each was ruled by an Emir.

- **The Emir:**

- He was the governor or ruler of his emirate.
- He was appointed by the Caliph in Sokoto (or the Emir of Gwandu for the western zone). His appointment was symbolized by receiving a flag.
- **Duties of the Emir:**
 1. **Allegiance:** He had to be loyal to the Caliph.
 2. **Tribute:** He had to pay annual tribute (in the form of goods, slaves, or currency) to Sokoto.
 3. **Military:** He had to raise and lead an army for the Caliph's campaigns when called upon.

4. **Governance:** He was responsible for maintaining law and order and, most importantly, *ruling according to Shari'a law*.
 - **Autonomy:** As long as the Emir fulfilled these duties, he had considerable local autonomy to run his emirate's internal affairs.
- **Key Officials within an Emirate:** Each Emir replicated the central administration in his own capital. Key officials included:
 - **Galadima:** Head of the capital city administration.
 - **Madawaki (or Sarkin Yaki):** Commander-in-chief of the emirate's army.
 - **Waziri:** The Emir's own chief advisor.
 - **Sarkin Ruwa:** Chief of fishing/rivers.
 - **Sarkin Pawa:** Chief of butchers.
 - **Yari:** Chief of the prisons.

2.4 Taxation

The Caliphate's financial system was based on Islamic law, replacing the arbitrary taxes of the Hausa rulers.

1. **Zakat:** An obligatory religious alms tax on wealth and property, used to care for the poor. It is one of the Five Pillars of Islam.
2. **Jizya:** A protection tax levied on non-Muslim subjects (*dhimmi*) living within the Caliphate. In return, they were granted religious freedom and military protection.
3. **Kharaj:** A tax on land, particularly conquered land.
4. **Jangali:** The cattle tax, which had been a major grievance, was retained but was now regularized and governed by Islamic law, making it less arbitrary.
5. **Ghanima:** Spoils of war (a share of which was sent to Sokoto).

2.5 Justice and Governance

- The entire legal system was based on **Shari'a Law** (derived from the Qur'an and Hadith, following the Maliki school of jurisprudence).
- This replaced the Hausa rulers' mix of Islamic law and traditional customs.

- The system was administered by **Alkali** (judges).
- An *Alkali* was an educated scholar appointed by the Emir. He presided over a Shari'a court.
- Cases were heard and judged strictly according to Islamic legal texts.
- The Emir's court was a higher court of appeal, and the Caliph's court in Sokoto was the supreme court of the Caliphate.
- This system was seen as much fairer and less corrupt than the one it replaced.

Evaluation

1. What is a "theocracy"?
2. Who was the first Caliph, and who succeeded him as the second Caliph?
3. Explain the administrative "duality" of Sokoto and Gwandu. Who led each part?
4. What were the three main duties an Emir owed to the Caliph in Sokoto?
5. Define the following terms: *Alkali*, *Zakat*, and *Jizya*.

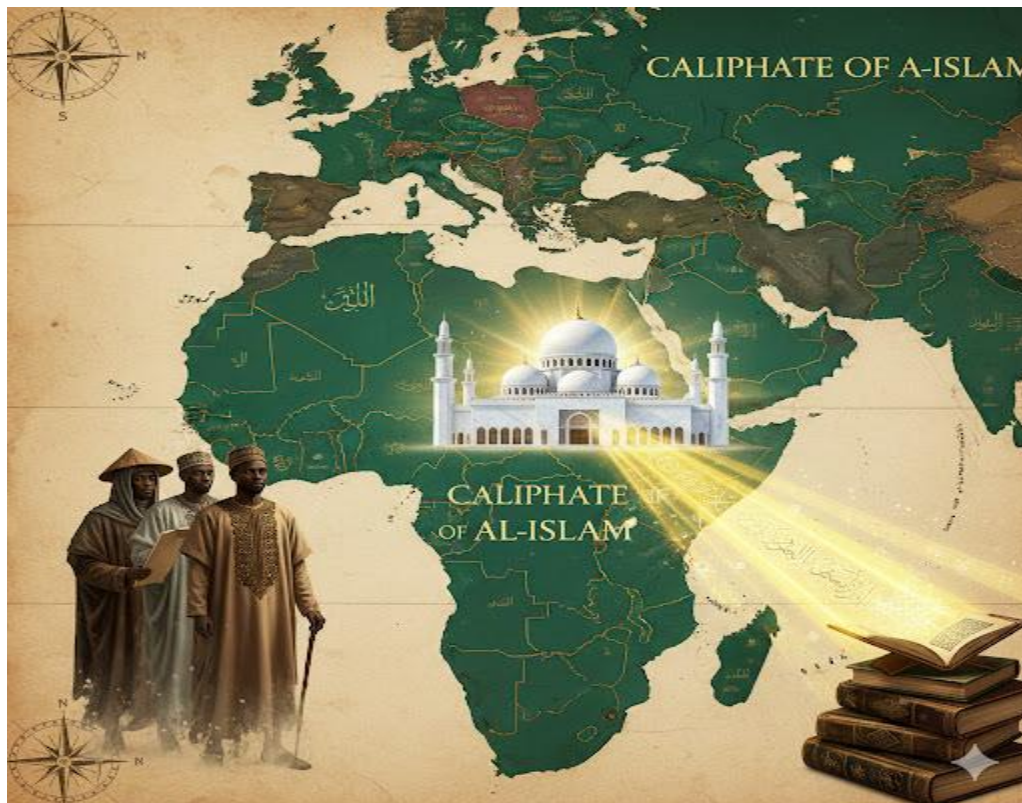
Assignment

1. Draw a political organogram (structure chart) of the Sokoto CaliphATE, showing the relationship between the Caliph, the Emir of Gwandu, and a local Emir.
2. "The administrative system of the Sokoto CaliphATE was a significant improvement on the old Hausa political structure." Discuss, providing three examples.

WEEK 3: THE IMPACT OF THE JIHAD

3.1 Introduction

The Sokoto Jihad was one of the most significant events in West African history. Its consequences were profound and are still evident today. It permanently reshaped the political, religious, social, and educational landscape of Northern Nigeria and beyond.



3.2 Political Transformations

1. **Creation of a Unified Empire:** The jihad's most obvious impact was the destruction of the 14 independent and warring Hausa states and their replacement with a single, vast, and centralized empire—the Sokoto Caliphate.
2. **New Ruling Aristocracy:** The old Hausa dynasties (Habe rulers) were overthrown and replaced by a new Fulani-led aristocracy. The "flag-bearers" of the jihad and

their descendants became the new Emirs, establishing new ruling dynasties that continue to this day (e.g., in Kano, Zaria, Katsina).

3. **End of Inter-State Warfare:** The constant, petty wars between the Hausa states, which had destabilized the region, were brought to an end. Peace and security (*Pax Islamica*) were established over a vast area, stimulating trade and agriculture.
4. **Inspiration for Other Jihads:** The success of Usman dan Fodio's jihad inspired a wave of similar reformist movements across West Africa in the 19th century. These included the jihad of Seku Amadu in Masina, and the jihad of Al-Hajj Umar Tal in the Tukulor Empire.
5. **Defined Borders:** The jihad and the Caliphate's expansion defined the political geography of Northern Nigeria, establishing a major bloc that the future British colonizers would have to confront (and later incorporate as "Northern Nigeria").

3.3 Religious Transformations

1. **Purification and Spread of Islam:** This was the primary *goal* of the jihad. Islam was "purified" of syncretic and animist (Bori) practices. It spread to new areas and was deepened in existing Muslim communities.
2. **Supremacy of Shari'a Law:** Islamic law (Shari'a) became the official legal code of the entire empire, governing everything from criminal justice and commerce to personal family matters. The *Ulama* (scholars) and *Alkali* (judges) became a powerful and essential part of the state.
3. **Mass Conversion:** Many animist communities and "lapsed" Muslims converted to Islam, either through conviction or through political pressure, swelling the ranks of the faithful.

3.4 Social Transformations

1. **Creation of a "Hausa-Fulani" Identity:** Although the jihad was led by Fulani, they were a minority in the region. Over time, the Fulani rulers intermarried with the local Hausa population, adopted the Hausa language (which, ironically, became the

lingua franca of the Caliphate, not Fulfulde), and absorbed Hausa culture. This led to the creation of a new, blended "Hausa-Fulani" identity.

2. **Increase in Slavery:** This is a major negative consequence. The jihad was a "war," and Islamic law at the time permitted the enslavement of those who resisted (deemed *kafir*). This led to the capture of many non-Muslims and even "unbelieving" Muslims. These slaves were used in households and on large slave-worked plantations (*rinji*), which produced grain and other goods for the Caliphate's economy.
3. **New Social Stratification:** A new social hierarchy emerged:
 - **The Ruling Class:** The Fulani Emirs, their families, and top officials.
 - **The Ulama:** The respected class of Islamic scholars, judges, and teachers.
 - **The Talakawa:** The free-born Hausa and Fulani commoners (farmers, merchants, artisans).
 - **Slaves:** The bottom of the social ladder.

3.5 Educational and Intellectual Transformations

1. **Flourishing of Islamic Scholarship:** The jihad was led by scholars, and the Caliphate they built was a state that valued knowledge. Sokoto, Gwandu, Kano, and Katsina became major centers of Islamic learning.
2. **Increased Literacy:** Arabic literacy (the language of the Qur'an and scholarship) spread rapidly.
3. **Massive Literary Output:** The leaders of the jihad were prolific authors. Usman dan Fodio, Muhammadu Bello, and Abdullahi of Gwandu wrote *hundreds* of books and poems on theology, law, politics, history, and ethics. This intellectual legacy is one of the richest in African history.
4. **Promotion of Education:** The state encouraged the establishment of Qur'anic schools for both boys and girls. Usman dan Fodio himself was a strong advocate for the education of women, including his own daughters (like Nana Asma'u).

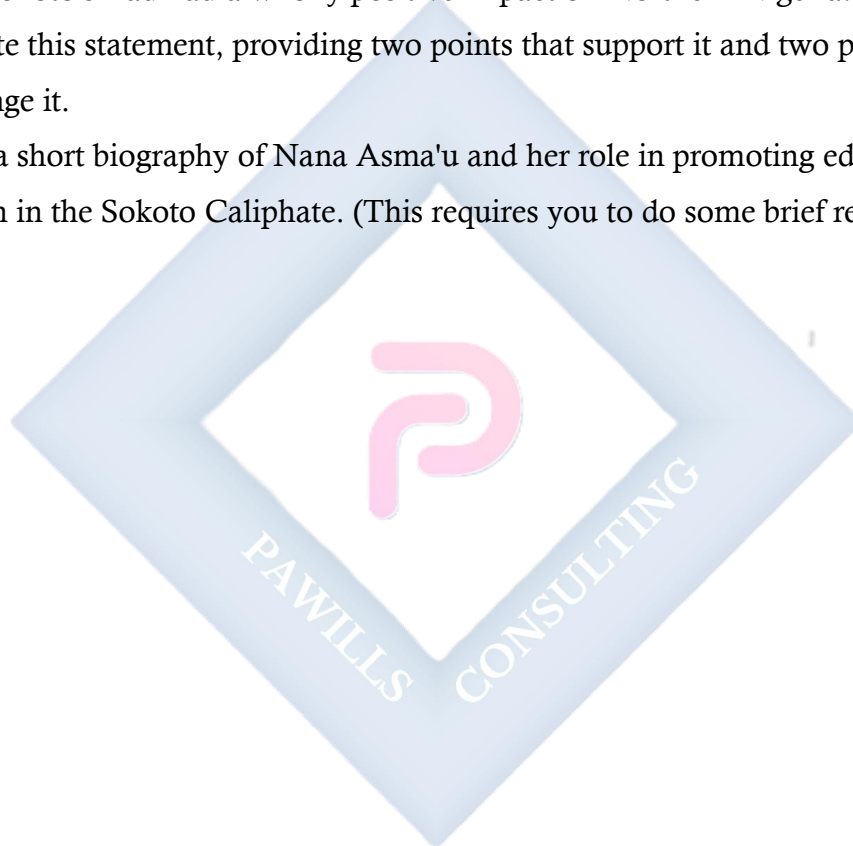
Evaluation

1. Name two major political impacts of the Sokoto Jihad.

2. What was the official legal system of the Caliphate?
3. Explain the origin of the "Hausa-Fulani" identity.
4. What was a negative social consequence of the jihad?
5. Who were the three main intellectual figures of the Caliphate who wrote hundreds of books?

Assignment

1. "The Sokoto Jihad had a wholly positive impact on Northern Nigeria." Critically evaluate this statement, providing two points that support it and two points that challenge it.
2. Write a short biography of Nana Asma'u and her role in promoting education for women in the Sokoto Caliphate. (This requires you to do some brief research).



WEEK 4: BORNU UNDER THE SHEHUS: THE EMERGENCE OF EL-KANEMI

4.1 Introduction: The Decline of the Sefawa Dynasty

While the jihad was transforming Hausaland, the neighbouring empire of **Bornu** was facing its own crisis. Bornu was one of Africa's oldest and most enduring empires, ruled by the **Sefawa Dynasty** for nearly 1,000 years (since the 9th century).



By the late 18th and early 19th centuries, the Sefawa dynasty was in a state of severe decline:

- **Weak Rulers:** The *Mais* (Kings) of Bornu had become decadent, weak, and isolated in their palaces. They were figureheads with no real power.
- **Corrupt Nobility:** Real power was held by a corrupt and factious aristocracy that often fought among itself.

- **Economic Decline:** The trans-Saharan trade routes, which had been Bornu's lifeblood, were shifting, and the economy was weakening.
- **Military Ineffectiveness:** The once-mighty Bornu army was outdated and unable to defend the empire's borders.

4.2 The Sokoto Jihad and the Attack on Bornu

The Sokoto jihadists, fresh from their victories in Hausaland, turned their attention to Bornu. Fulani clerics within Bornu's borders rose up, accusing the Sefawa *Mais* of being "unbelievers" and "syncretists," just as they had accused the Hausa *Sarkis*.

- **The Fall of the Capital:** In 1808, the jihadists (led by local Fulani leaders like Gwoni Mukhtar) attacked Bornu. The Sefawa army collapsed. The *Mai* of Bornu, Dunama IX, was forced to flee as the jihadists captured and sacked the ancient capital of **Ngazargamu**.

4.3 The Rise of Muhammad al-Amin El-Kanemi

In this moment of total collapse, *Mai* Dunama appealed for help from a respected Islamic scholar and warrior who lived in the province of Kanem. His name was **Muhammad al-Amin El-Kanemi** (often shortened to El-Kanemi).

- **Who was El-Kanemi?**
 - He was *not* from the Sefawa dynasty.
 - He was of Kanembu and Shuwa Arab ancestry.
 - He was a renowned scholar and military strategist who had a large following of his own, especially among Kanembu and Shuwa Arab warriors.
- **El-Kanemi's Counter-Jihad:**
 - El-Kanemi agreed to help the *Mai*... for a price (control of territory and power).
 - He assembled his army and launched a brilliant military campaign *against* the Sokoto jihadists.

- He successfully recaptured Ngazargamu and drove the Fulani forces out of Bornu's heartland.
- **The Famous Intellectual Debate:**
 - El-Kanemi did not just fight with weapons; he also fought with ideas.
 - He engaged in a famous series of letters with the Sokoto leaders (Usman dan Fodio and Muhammadu Bello).
 - **Sokoto's Argument:** The *Mai* of Bornu is an unbeliever, oppresses his people, and allows paganism. Therefore, the jihad against him is just.
 - **El-Kanemi's Argument:** Bornu is, and has been, an Islamic state for 800 years. Its rulers are Muslims. If they are "bad" Muslims, the solution is *reform*, not a bloody invasion. He argued that the Sokoto jihad in Bornu was not for religion but for political power and plunder.

4.4 His Reforms and Leadership: The Dual Monarchy

El-Kanemi's success made him the *de facto* (in reality) ruler of Bornu. The Sefawa *Mais* were powerless and owed their throne to him.

- **The Title "Shehu":** El-Kanemi was too clever to depose the 1,000-year-old dynasty. This might have caused a civil war. Instead, he allowed the *Mai* to continue existing as a symbolic, figurehead ruler.
- El-Kanemi took the simple title of **Shehu** (from the Arabic *Sheikh*, meaning "leader" or "scholar").
- **A Dual Monarchy:** This created a unique "dual monarchy" system:
 1. **The *Mai* (Sefawa):** Lived in a separate palace, held the traditional court, and was the *de jure* (by law) king. He had no real power.
 2. **The *Shehu* (El-Kanemi):** Held the *real* military and administrative power. He was the *de facto* ruler.
- **A New Capital:** The old capital, Ngazargamu, was destroyed. El-Kanemi built a new capital for himself at **Kukawa** in 1814.
- **Reforms:**

- He began rebuilding the army, basing it on his loyal Kanembu and Shuwa Arab followers, not the old, disloyal Sefawa nobility.
- He replaced the corrupt Sefawa nobles with his own trusted companions, known as *Kachellawa* (military commanders).
- He sought to restore Bornu's economy and re-establish the supremacy of Shari'a law.

Evaluation

1. What was the name of the 1,000-year-old dynasty that ruled Bornu?
2. List two reasons for the decline of the Sefawa dynasty.
3. Why did the Sokoto jihadists attack Bornu in 1808?
4. Who was Muhammad El-Kanemi, and how did he come to power?
5. What was the "dual monarchy" system, and what title did El-Kanemi take?

Assignment

1. Compare and contrast the arguments of the Sokoto leaders and El-Kanemi regarding the jihad in Bornu. Who do you think had a stronger argument, and why?
2. In what ways was El-Kanemi's rise to power different from Usman dan Fodio's?

WEEK 5: MIDTERM EXAMINATION

(This week is for examinations based on the content from Weeks 1-4. No new lesson notes.)



WEEK 6: DEVELOPMENTS UNDER EL-KANEMI AND THE SHEHUS

6.1 Introduction

After emerging as the savior of Bornu, Muhammad El-Kanemi (who ruled c. 1814-1837) and his successors consolidated their power, reorganized the state, and established a new dynasty that would rule Bornu until the end of the 19th century.



6.2 The End of the Sefawa Dynasty

The "dual monarchy" (with a powerless *Mai* and a powerful *Shehu*) was an awkward arrangement. It could not last forever.

- Muhammad El-Kanemi was succeeded by his son, **Shehu Umar** (who had a long reign, 1837-1881).
- In 1846, the Sefawa puppet, *Mai Ibrahim*, conspired with the Sultan of Wadai (a neighbouring kingdom) to overthrow Shehu Umar and regain Sefawa power.

- Shehu Umar decisively crushed this rebellion. He defeated both the *Mai* and the forces of Wadai.
- After this act of treason, Shehu Umar **executed *Mai Ibrahim*** and his sons.
- With this act, the **Sefawa dynasty was formally and permanently abolished** after ruling for nearly a millennium.
- Shehu Umar (and his father El-Kanemi) established the new **Kanemi (or Shehu) Dynasty** as the sole rulers of Bornu, *de jure* and *de facto*.

6.3 Reorganization of Bornu Administration

El-Kanemi and Shehu Umar had to rebuild Bornu from scratch. They based the new administration on El-Kanemi's loyal followers, not the old Sefawa nobility.

1. Central Government:

- The **Shehu** was the supreme political, military, and religious leader.
- He was assisted by a **Council** (*Nokena*) composed of his most trusted relatives and companions (*Kachellawa*).
- The *Waziri* (Vizier) was the Shehu's chief administrator.
- The capital at **Kukawa** was built as a large, fortified city and became a major center for trans-Saharan trade and Islamic learning.

2. Provincial Administration:

- The old Sefawa system of fief-holding (granting land to nobles) was abolished, as it had made the nobles too powerful.
- Instead, El-Kanemi appointed officials called **Koguna** (district heads) who were directly responsible to him.
- He also placed his loyal military commanders (*Kachellawa*) in charge of key provinces to ensure security and loyalty.

6.4 Resistance to the Sokoto Caliphate

A key feature of El-Kanemi's and Shehu Umar's reigns was the successful **resistance to the Sokoto Caliphate**.

- El-Kanemi's military victories and intellectual arguments had permanently *halted* the Sokoto jihad at Bornu's western border.
- Bornu **never** became part of the Sokoto Caliphate. It remained a powerful, independent, and rival Islamic empire throughout the 19th century.
- The border between Bornu and the Sokoto Caliphate (specifically the Hadejia and Katagum emirates) remained a site of occasional raids and skirmishes, but neither side could conquer the other.

6.5 Restoration of Stability

- Under El-Kanemi and Shehu Umar, Bornu regained much of its former strength.
- Internal stability was restored, and law and order (based on Shari'a) were re-established.
- The trans-Saharan trade routes were revived. Kukawa became a major terminus, trading with North Africa (Tripoli) in goods like slaves, ivory, ostrich feathers, and leather goods.
- Bornu re-asserted its dominance over the Lake Chad region.
- This period represented a "silver age" for Bornu, restoring its position as a major regional power.

Evaluation

1. Who was Shehu Umar, and what was his relationship to El-Kanemi?
2. How and in what year was the Sefawa dynasty finally abolished?
3. What was the new capital of Bornu under the Shehus?
4. Who were the *Kachellawa* and *Koguna* in El-Kanemi's administration?
5. What was Bornu's political relationship with the Sokoto Caliphate throughout the 19th century?

Assignment

1. "Muhammad El-Kanemi was a reformer, not a revolutionary." Discuss this statement, comparing his actions to those of Usman dan Fodio.

2. Explain the economic basis of Bornu's stability under the Shehu dynasty.



WEEK 7: MIDTERM BREAK

(This week is for a midterm break. No new lesson notes.)



WEEK 8: YORUBA LAND IN THE 19TH CENTURY: OYO EMPIRE

8.1 Introduction: The Old Oyo Empire at its Peak

Before the 19th century, the **Oyo Empire** was the dominant political and military power in Yorubaland.

- It was a vast empire, with its capital at **Oyo-Ile** (Old Oyo).
- Its power rested on its formidable **cavalry** (horse-based army), which was effective in the open savanna.
- It controlled a vast territory, including vassal states like the Egba, Egbado, and, most importantly, the coastal kingdom of Dahomey, which gave it access to the Atlantic slave trade.



8.2 The Political Structure of Old Oyo

The empire had a sophisticated system of "checks and balances":

1. **The Alaafin:** The emperor of Oyo. He was seen as *Ekeji Orisa* (companion of the gods) and held supreme, semi-divine authority.
2. **The Oyo Mesi:** The Council of Seven, composed of the heads of the seven non-royal wards of the capital.
 - They were the kingmakers.
 - Their leader was the **Bashorun** (Prime Minister).
 - The Oyo Mesi had the constitutional power to "reject" an Alaafin by presenting him with an **empty calabash** (*igba iwa*), a sentence that meant the Alaafin had to commit ritual suicide. This was the ultimate check on his power.
3. **The Ogboni:** A powerful, secret society of elders, priests, and notable figures. The Ogboni cult served as a check on *both* the Alaafin and the Oyo Mesi, ensuring neither became too powerful.
4. **The Aare Ona Kakanfo:** The Generalissimo, or Field Marshal, of the Oyo army. He was the supreme military commander. By tradition, he was forbidden from living in the capital, Oyo-Ile, to prevent him from using the army to stage a coup.

8.3 The Decline and Fall of the Oyo Empire

The 19th century witnessed the total and catastrophic collapse of this great empire. The causes were both internal and external.

- **Internal Conflicts:**

1. **Constitutional Breakdown:** The delicate balance of power between the Alaafin and the Bashorun broke down. In the late 18th century, **Bashorun Gaa** became overmighty, reportedly deposing and executing four successive Alaafins, creating deep instability.
2. **Rebellion of Afonja (c. 1817):** The *Aare Ona Kakanfo* at the time, **Afonja**, was based in Ilorin, a major Oyo provincial town. He entered into a bitter

personal and political struggle with the reigning Alaafin Aole. Afonja decided to rebel and break Ilorin away from the Oyo Empire.

- **External Pressures (The Fulani Factor):**

1. **Afonja's Fatal Alliance:** To win his rebellion, Afonja needed a strong army. He invited a charismatic Fulani cleric, **Alim al-Salih** (known as *Alimi*), and his *jama'a* (a mix of Fulani pastoralists, Hausa slaves, and other jihadist followers) to settle in Ilorin and become his private army.
2. **The Jama'a Takeover:** This plan backfired disastrously. Afonja's new army (the *jama'a*) grew more powerful than he was. They were inspired by the Sokoto Jihad to the north. Soon, they turned on Afonja, killing him around 1824.
3. **Ilorin Becomes an Emirate:** Alimi's son, **Abdulsalam**, took control of Ilorin. He declared himself Emir and pledged allegiance to the Sokoto Caliphate.
4. **The Ilorin Jihad:** Ilorin, once Oyo's key northern province, was now an aggressive enemy emirate and a base for the Sokoto Caliphate to launch a jihad south into the rest of Yorubaland.

- **The Final Collapse:**

1. The Ilorin cavalry, led by the Fulani, attacked the remnants of the Oyo Empire.
2. In a series of battles (like the Battle of Ogele), the Oyo army was defeated.
3. Vassal states, like the Egba (who founded Abeokuta) and Dahomey, took the opportunity to declare independence.
4. The capital, **Oyo-Ile, was sacked and destroyed** (c. 1835-1837).
5. The empire completely disintegrated. The Oyo people fled south, and the Alaafin's son, Atiba, eventually founded a new, much smaller capital at **Oyo-Atiba** (the present-day Oyo town).

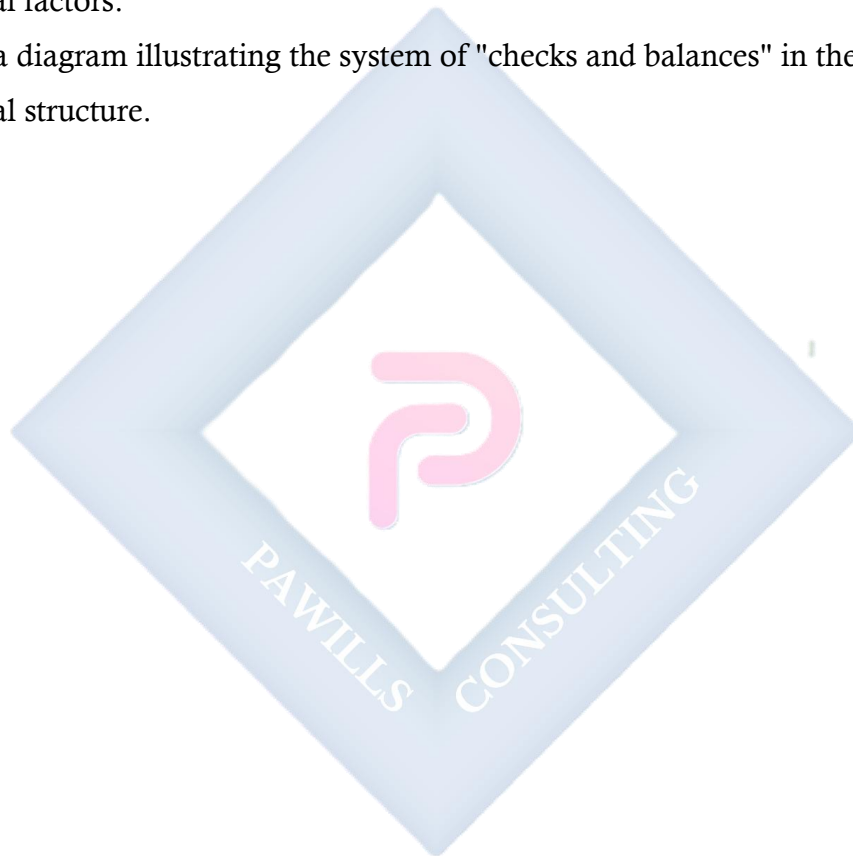
Evaluation

1. What was the capital of the Old Oyo Empire?
2. Define the roles of the *Alaafin*, the *Bashorun*, and the *Aare Ona Kakanfo*.

3. What did it mean when the *Oyo Mesi* presented the *Alaafin* with an "empty calabash"?
4. Who was Afonja, and what fatal mistake did he make in his rebellion?
5. What northern power took control of Ilorin and turned it into an emirate?

Assignment

1. "The collapse of the Old Oyo Empire was caused more by internal decay than by external attack." Discuss this statement, providing evidence for both internal and external factors.
2. Draw a diagram illustrating the system of "checks and balances" in the Old Oyo political structure.



WEEK 9: THE ERA OF IBADAN IMPERIALISM

9.1 The Power Vacuum and the Rise of New States

The collapse of the Oyo Empire (c. 1837) created a massive power vacuum and a period of chaos. Refugees (*son-of-a-bitch*) fled south, and the old order vanished. This led to the rise of new, powerful "successor states," which were often founded as war camps. The two most important were **Abeokuta** (founded by Egba refugees) and **Ibadan**.



9.2 The Rise of Ibadan (c. 1829)

- **A Military Republic:** Ibadan was founded around 1829 by a mix of Ife, Ijebu, and refugee Oyo warriors. It was not a traditional kingdom. It was a **republican military state**.

- **Government by Merit:** Ibadan had no *Oba* (king) in the traditional sense. Its leadership was based on military prowess and achievement, not heredity.
- **The Two Chieftaincy Lines:** Power was divided into two parallel lines of chiefs:
 1. **The Civil Line (Baale):** This line was headed by the **Baale** (later titled *Olubadan*). This was the senior-most chief, but he was not an absolute monarch.
 2. **The Military Line (Balogun):** This line was headed by the **Balogun** (commander of the army).
- A man started at the bottom of a line and was promoted to a higher title based on his success in war, his wealth, and his influence. This made Ibadan a *meritocracy* that attracted ambitious and ruthless warriors from all over Yorubaland.

9.3 Ibadan Imperialism: The "Successor" to Oyo

Ibadan quickly became the most powerful military force in Yorubaland. Its leaders saw themselves as the true successors to the old Oyo Empire. Their "imperial" goals were twofold:

1. **To Stop the Ilorin/Fulani Advance:** To prevent the Sokoto Caliphate from conquering all of Yorubaland.
 2. **To Control Trade Routes:** To control the lucrative trade routes to the coast (Lagos and Badagry) to import European firearms and gunpowder.
- **The Battle of Osogbo (c. 1840):** This was Ibadan's defining moment. The Ilorin-Fulani army, having destroyed Oyo-Ile, was pushing deep into Yorubaland. They laid siege to Osogbo. The Ibadan army, led by Balogun Oderinlo, marched north and inflicted a *crushing* defeat on the Ilorin cavalry.
 - **Significance:** This battle **permanently halted the Fulani jihad's advance** into the Yoruba forest regions. Ibadan was hailed as the "savior of Yorubaland."

9.4 The *Ajele* System and the Kiriji War

After Osogbo, Ibadan began its own wars of expansion, creating a large empire.

- It conquered and dominated large parts of Yorubaland, especially the Ijesha, Ekiti, Akoko, and Ife territories.
- **The *Ajele* System:** To rule this empire, Ibadan placed resident "governors" or agents, called *Ajele*, in the subject towns.
- **Oppression:** The *Ajele* system quickly became corrupt and oppressive. The *Ajeles* were often arrogant, brutal, and extorted taxes and property from the local people.
- **The Ekiti-Parapo Coalition:** The oppressive rule of the Ibadan *Ajeles* led to a massive rebellion. The Ijesha and Ekiti kingdoms formed a powerful military alliance called the **Ekiti-Parapo** ("Ekiti-together").
- They were led by a brilliant Ijesha warrior named **Ogedengbe of Ilesa**.
- **The Kiriji War (c. 1877-1893):**
 - The Ekiti-Parapo rebellion sparked the longest and most destructive war in Yoruba history, known as the **Kiriji War** (or 16-Years' War).
 - It was Ibadan vs. the Ekiti-Parapo, who were soon joined by Ilorin, Ijebu, and Ife, forming a "Grand Alliance" to crush Ibadan.
 - The war gets its name, "Kiriji," from the sound "ki-ri-jiii" that the new, long-range breach-loading rifles (bought from Europeans) made, which both sides used for the first time.
 - The war became a long, bloody stalemate in the hills of Ijeshaland, weakening all of Yorubaland.

Evaluation

1. How was the political system of Ibadan different from that of Old Oyo?
2. What were the two parallel lines of chieftaincy in Ibadan?
3. What was the significance of the Battle of Osogbo (c. 1840)?
4. What was the *Ajele* system?
5. What was the "Ekiti-Parapo," and who was its most famous general?

Assignment

1. "Ibadan was both the savior and the oppressor of Yorubaland." Discuss this paradox, using specific examples.
2. Explain the causes, course, and nature of the Kiriji War.



WEEK 10: THE PEACE TREATY OF 1886 AND ITS AFTERMATH

10.1 Introduction: The Stalemate

By the mid-1880s, the Kiriji War had been raging for nearly a decade. It had devolved into a massive, entrenched stalemate.

- **Ibadan:** Still held the military advantage in open-field battles but could not break the Ekiti-Parapo's defenses in the hills. Its army was exhausted.
- **The Ekiti-Parapo:** Were determined to win their independence but lacked the offensive power to destroy Ibadan.
- **Ijebu and Egba:** Controlled the trade routes from the coast and blockaded Ibadan, preventing them from getting fresh supplies of firearms.
- The entire region was suffering from famine, depopulation, and the collapse of all normal trade and farming.



10.2 British Intervention

The British, who had established the **Lagos Colony** in 1861, were growing increasingly concerned.

1. **Trade:** The war was disastrous for "legitimate trade" (in palm oil, etc.), which the British wanted to promote.
2. **Missionary Pressure:** Christian missionaries (like Rev. Samuel Johnson, who was also a Yoruba historian) were active in the interior and pleaded with the British government in Lagos to intervene and stop the bloodshed.
3. **Humanitarian Concerns:** The Lagos government, under Governor Alfred Moloney, saw the war as a humanitarian crisis.

In 1886, the Lagos government sent special commissioners (Higgins and Oliver) into the interior to mediate a peace agreement.

10.3 The Peace Treaty of 1886

The warring factions, exhausted and under pressure from the British mediators, met at a village called **Igbajo** to sign a peace treaty.

- **Key Terms of the Treaty:**

1. **Cessation of Hostilities:** An immediate end to the fighting.
2. **Independence for the Ekiti-Parapo:** This was the most important term. **Ibadan agreed to recognize the full independence** of all the towns in the Ekiti-Parapo confederation.
3. **Abolition of the *Ajele* System:** Ibadan was to withdraw all its *Ajeles* from Ijesha and Ekiti lands.
4. **Disbandment of Armies:** All armies were to be disbanded, and the warriors were to return to their hometowns.
5. **Ilorin and Offa:** The status of Offa (a town disputed by Ilorin and Ibadan) was left ambiguous, which would cause problems later.
6. **A New Era of Peace:** The treaty was meant to end all wars in Yorubaland and establish permanent peace.

10.4 The Aftermath

- **A Fragile Peace:** The treaty was signed, but the deep-seated hatred and mistrust remained. The armies did not disband immediately, as no side trusted the other to lay down its arms first. The war continued in a low-intensity form.
- **The Rise of British Power:** The *most significant* consequence of the 1886 Treaty was not the peace it created, but the power it gave to the British. It showed that the Yoruba states were now incapable of solving their own problems. The British, as mediators, had become the new "power brokers" in the region.
- **The "Scramble for Africa" and Final Conquest:**
 - The treaty was signed during the "Scramble for Africa." The British used the continued instability as a pretext to impose their own rule.
 - The French were advancing from the west (Dahomey), and the British were determined to claim Yorubaland for themselves.
 - In 1892, the British attacked the Ijebu (who were blocking trade) in the **Ijebu-Egba War**.
 - In 1893, the new Governor of Lagos, **Sir Gilbert Carter**, marched with troops through all of Yorubaland (the "Carter's Trek"). He went to Abeokuta, Ibadan, and the new Oyo, forcing their leaders to sign treaties that placed them under "British Protection."
 - This action in 1893, not the 1886 treaty, truly ended the Kiriji War and, with it, the independence of all the Yoruba states. The colonial era had begun.

Evaluation

1. Why did the Kiriji War become a "stalemate"?
2. Give two reasons why the British in Lagos decided to intervene in the war.
3. What was the single most important term of the 1886 Peace Treaty for the Ekiti-Parapo?
4. Why did the 1886 treaty fail to bring immediate, lasting peace?
5. What was the ultimate long-term consequence of the British mediation and the 1886 treaty?

Assignment

1. "The 1886 Peace Treaty was a greater victory for the British than for any of the Yoruba states." Discuss this statement.
2. Imagine you are a Yoruba warrior in 1886. Write a short letter to your family explaining why you are both happy and suspicious about the new peace treaty.

WEEK 11: REVISION

(This week is dedicated to a comprehensive review of all topics covered during the first term. Students should review their notes from Weeks 1-10 in preparation for the First Term Examination.)

- **Key Areas for Review:**

- **Sokoto Caliphate:** Causes, course, and effects of the 1804 Jihad; the administrative structure (Caliph, Emirs, *Waziri*, *Alkali*); and the political, social, and intellectual impacts.
- **Bornu Empire:** The decline of the Sefawa, the rise of Muhammad El-Kanemi, the "dual monarchy," the end of the Sefawa, and the reorganization of Bornu under the Shehu dynasty.
- **Yorubaland:** The structure and collapse of the Old Oyo Empire (Afonja, Ilorin); the rise of Ibadan as a military republic; the Battle of Osogbo; the *Ajele* system; and the causes, course, and consequences of the Kiriji War and the 1886 Peace Treaty.

SS2 NIGERIAN HISTORY LESSON NOTES

SECOND TERM

WEEK 1: BENIN IN THE 19TH CENTURY

1.1 INTRODUCTION: THE KINGDOM OF BENIN

By the 19th century, the Benin Kingdom was one of the oldest, most powerful, and most organizationally complex states in West Africa. It had a long history of centralized power, artistic achievement (especially its brass/bronze casting), and international diplomacy, having established relations with Portugal as early as the 15th century. Its capital, Benin City, was a vast, well-planned urban center protected by massive earthen walls.



1.2 STRUCTURE AND POLITICAL ORGANIZATION

The political structure of Benin was a highly centralized monarchy, with the Oba at the apex of all power.

- **THE OBA (KING):**

- The Oba was the supreme political, religious, and military leader of the kingdom.
- He was considered semi-divine and was the "owner" of all land in Benin.
- His authority was absolute, though in practice it was balanced by various chieftaincy groups.
- He ruled from a vast palace complex in the center of the city.
- **CHIEFTAINCY GROUPS:** The Oba's administration was run by three main categories of chiefs:
 1. **THE UZAMA NIHINRON (THE KINGMAKERS):** This was the council of the seven highest-ranking hereditary nobles (led by the *Oliha*). They were responsible for crowning a new Oba and represented the most ancient lineages of the kingdom. They held significant power and could act as a check on the Oba.
 2. **THE EGHAEVBO N'ORE (THE TOWN CHIEFS):** This was a group of "palace chiefs" who ran the day-to-day administration of the palace and state. They were non-hereditary, meaning they were appointed by the Oba based on merit and service. This allowed the Oba to create a loyal bureaucracy to counter the power of the hereditary *Uzama*.
 3. **THE EGHAEVBO N'OGBE (THE PALACE GUILDS):** These were the chiefs who managed the Oba's household and the various craft guilds (like brass casters, woodcarvers, and ivory carvers). They were divided into three main palace associations:
 - **Iwebo:** In charge of the Oba's regalia, wardrobe, and dealings with Europeans.
 - **Iweguae:** The Oba's personal servants and domestic staff.
 - **Ibiwe:** Looked after the Oba's wives and children.

This complex system of hereditary chiefs, appointed chiefs, and palace guilds created a sophisticated balance of power, all centered on the divine authority of the Oba.

1.3 TRADE AND DIPLOMACY

- **TRADE:**

- Benin's economy was built on trade, both internal and external (with its neighbors and with Europeans at the coast).
- Initially (15th-18th centuries), the main exports were slaves, ivory, and pepper.
- By the 19th century, following the British abolition of the slave trade, the main export had shifted to **palm oil** and palm kernels.
- **The Oba's Monopoly:** The Oba maintained a royal monopoly over all key areas of the economy, especially the trade in palm oil and ivory. This meant only he, or his designated agents, could legally sell these goods to Europeans. This policy was a major source of conflict with British traders.
- **DIPLOMACY:**
 - Benin had a long tradition of diplomacy. The Oba sent and received ambassadors.
 - Its earliest diplomatic ties were with Portugal.
 - In the 19th century, its main diplomatic challenge was managing the growing and increasingly aggressive power of Great Britain.

1.4 BRITISH RELATIONS

Relations between Benin and Britain deteriorated steadily throughout the 19th century.

1. **Economic Conflict:** British traders, led by firms like the Royal Niger Company, wanted "free trade." They hated the Oba's monopoly, which kept prices high.
2. **Missionary Pressure:** Christian missionaries saw Benin as a "pagan" kingdom, citing its practice of human sacrifice (an important part of its state religion) as a reason for British intervention.
3. **Political Pressure:** The British, establishing control over the coast, saw Benin as a powerful independent state standing in the way of their colonial ambitions.
4. **The "Gallwey Treaty" (1892):** Vice-Consul Harry Gallwey visited Benin and pressured **Oba Ovonramwen Nogbaisi** to sign a treaty. The treaty, written in English, promised "free trade" and placed Benin under British "protection." The Oba and his chiefs later stated they never agreed to sign away their sovereignty and had no intention of abandoning their trade monopoly.

This clash of interests (Benin's sovereignty vs. Britain's economic and imperial ambitions) set the stage for the violent conquest that would follow.

EVALUATION

1. What was the title of the Oba's kingmakers/hereditary nobles?
2. Name the two other main categories of chiefs in the Benin administrative structure.
3. What was the main export commodity from Benin in the late 19th century, and who controlled its trade?
4. What was the "Gallwey Treaty" of 1892, and why did it cause conflict?
5. Who was the Oba of Benin during this period of increasing conflict with the British?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Draw a political organogram (structure chart) of the Benin Kingdom, showing the relationship between the Oba and the three main chieftaincy groups.
2. "The conflict between Benin and Britain in the 19th century was primarily economic." Do you agree or disagree? Provide three points to support your answer.

WEEK 2: THE FIRST PHASE OF BRITISH CONQUEST (1851–1900)

2.1 INTRODUCTION

The second half of the 19th century was the period when Britain moved from being a trading partner to an imperial conqueror. This "first phase" of conquest was not a coordinated plan but a series of aggressive actions, often led by local "men on the spot" (consuls, traders, and military officers), that focused on securing key coastal territories.



2.2 BRITISH INTERVENTION IN LAGOS (1851)

- **THE CONTEXT:** Lagos, a key coastal port, was plunged into a succession dispute between two rivals:
 - **Oba Akitoye:** The recognized Oba, who was more open to the British and the abolition of the slave trade.

- **Oba Kosoko:** Akitoye's nephew and a powerful usurper, who was a strong supporter of the slave trade.
- **BRITISH MOTIVES:**
 1. **Abolition:** To stop the transatlantic slave trade, of which Lagos was a major hub.
 2. **Trade:** To promote "legitimate" trade in palm oil.
 3. **Strategic:** To secure a safe base of operations on the West African coast.
- **THE BOMBARDMENT (1851):** The British Consul, John Beecroft, sided with Akitoye. When Kosoko refused to sign an anti-slavery treaty, a British naval squadron attacked and bombarded Lagos. Kosoko was defeated and fled.
- **THE AFTERMATH (1861):** The British re-installed Akitoye (and later his son, Dosunmu). However, in 1861, under the pretext of stopping the slave trade permanently, the British forced Oba Dosunmu to sign the **Treaty of Cession**. This treaty formally handed over Lagos to Britain, and it became a **Crown Colony**. This was the first part of Nigeria to be formally annexed.

2.3 THE CONQUEST OF BENIN (1897)

- **THE PRELUDE:** Relations, already poor (as seen in Week 1), collapsed after the Gallwey Treaty. Oba Ovonramwen continued to resist British interference.
- **THE "PHILLIPS MASSACRE" (JANUARY 1897):**
 - The acting Consul-General of the Niger Coast Protectorate, **James R. Phillips**, decided to force a meeting with the Oba to demand he abide by the treaty.
 - He was warned by the Oba not to come, as the sacred *Igue* festival was being celebrated, a time when the Oba could not see foreigners.
 - Phillips ignored the warnings and led an unarmed "trade mission" (which included officials, translators, and 250 porters disguised as carriers) toward Benin.
 - The delegation was ambushed by Benin soldiers. Phillips and most of his European officers were killed.
- **THE "BENIN PUNITIVE EXPEDITION" (FEBRUARY 1897):**

- The British response was immediate and overwhelming. They assembled a massive military force of 1,200 Royal Marines and sailors.
- The expedition, led by Admiral Sir Harry Rawson, invaded Benin City.
- The city was captured, systematically looted of its priceless art (the **Benin Bronzes**), and burned to the ground.
- Oba Ovonramwen was captured, put on trial, and exiled to Calabar, where he died in 1914.
- The Benin Kingdom was broken, and its territory was absorbed into the Niger Coast Protectorate.

2.4 ESTABLISHMENT OF PROTECTORATES

This phase of conquest was not just about annexing (like Lagos) but also about establishing "protectorates" (territories protected and controlled by Britain, but not formally colonies).

1. **OIL RIVERS PROTECTORATE (1885):** After the Berlin Conference, Britain declared a protectorate over the coastal areas from Calabar to the edge of Lagos. This was to secure the palm oil trade from rival powers (like Germany and France).
2. **NIGER COAST PROTECTORATE (1893):** The Oil Rivers Protectorate was expanded and given a more formal administration. This was the entity that conquered Benin in 1897.
3. **THE ROYAL NIGER COMPANY (RNC):** Meanwhile, Sir George Taubman Goldie's RNC had been given a royal charter in 1886 to administer the territories along the Niger and Benue rivers, effectively creating a *third* British-controlled entity in the region.

By 1900, Britain had three separate administrative territories in what would become Nigeria: Lagos Colony, the Niger Coast Protectorate, and the RNC's territories.

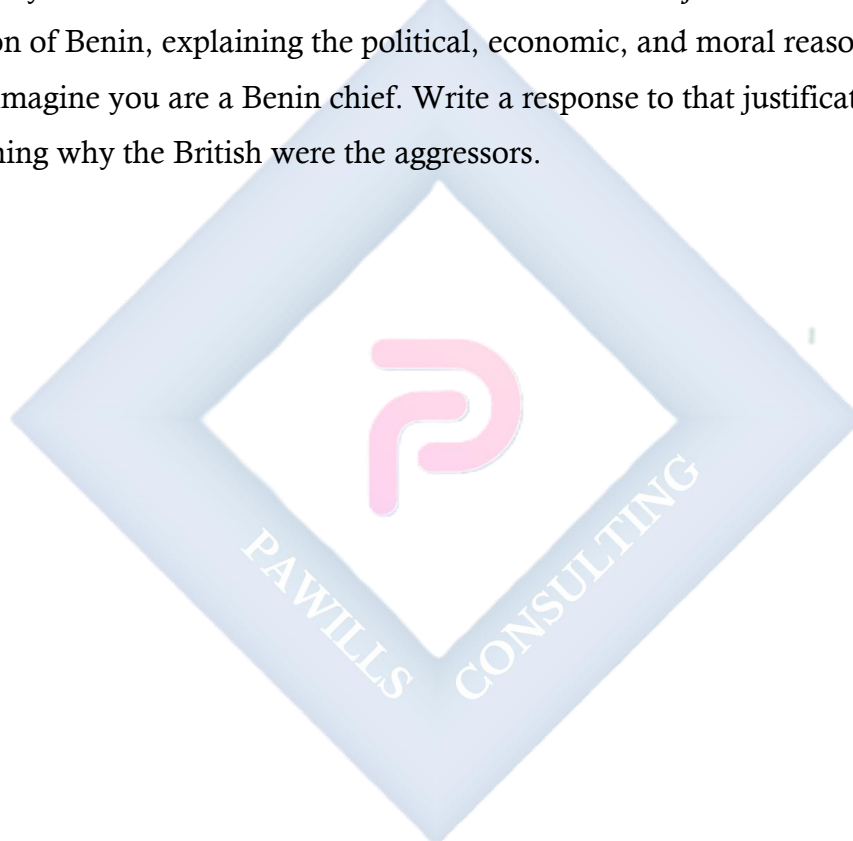
EVALUATION

1. Who were the two rival Obas in the 1851 Lagos succession dispute?
2. What was the Treaty of Cession (1861), and what did it achieve?

3. Who was James R. Phillips, and what happened to him in January 1897?
4. What was the "Benin Punitive Expedition," and what were its two major consequences?
5. What was the difference between a "Colony" (like Lagos) and a "Protectorate" (like the Oil Rivers)?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Imagine you are a British official in 1897. Write a formal justification for the invasion of Benin, explaining the political, economic, and moral reasons.
2. Now, imagine you are a Benin chief. Write a response to that justification, explaining why the British were the aggressors.



WEEK 3: THE SECOND PHASE OF BRITISH CONQUEST (1900–1914)

3.1 INTRODUCTION

While the "first phase" secured the coast, the "second phase" was a systematic, deliberate campaign to conquer the vast, powerful, and organized states of the interior, specifically the **Sokoto Caliphate**. This phase was masterminded by one man: **Lord Frederick Lugard**.



3.2 EXPANSION OF COLONIAL RULE TO THE NORTH

- **REVOCATION OF THE RNC CHARTER:** In 1900, the British government revoked the charter of the Royal Niger Company. The RNC was a business, not a

government, and it was ill-equipped to challenge the military power of the Sokoto Caliphate.

- **CREATION OF THE PROTECTORATE OF NORTHERN NIGERIA:** On January 1, 1900, Britain declared the Protectorate of Northern Nigeria. Lord Lugard was appointed its first High Commissioner.
- **THE WEST AFRICAN FRONTIER FORCE (WAFF):** Lugard's instrument of conquest was the WAFF, a well-armed, professional colonial army made up of African soldiers (often from Hausa and Yoruba lands) led by British officers.
- **THE CAMPAIGN OF CONQUEST:** Lugard's "expansion" was a military conquest, Emirate by Emirate.
 1. **Bida and Ilorin (1897, re-asserted 1901):** The RNC had previously defeated these emirates, but Lugard had to re-conquer them to establish firm British authority.
 2. **Yola and Bauchi (1901-1902):** These emirates were subdued.
 3. **Kano and Sokoto (1903):** This was the main campaign.
 - **Kano:** The city was a major commercial center with massive walls. The WAFF used artillery to breach the walls and captured the city after a short battle.
 - **Sokoto:** The Caliph, **Attahiru I**, fled Sokoto as Lugard's forces approached. A new, compliant Caliph was installed by Lugard.
 4. **THE BATTLE OF BURMI (1903):** Caliph Attahiru I did not give up. He raised a flag of *jihad* against the British invaders and rallied a large army. He made his last stand at Burmi (in present-day Gombe State). He and hundreds of his followers were killed in a fierce battle. This event marked the final, decisive end of the Sokoto Caliphate's independence.

3.3 THE USE OF INDIRECT RULE

Lugard had conquered a vast empire with very few British officials and very little money. It was impossible to rule it directly. This led him to devise the policy of **Indirect Rule**.

- **DEFINITION:** Indirect Rule was a system of colonial administration where the British ruled *through* the existing, traditional political structures and rulers.
- **WHY LUGARD USED IT IN THE NORTH:**
 1. **Pragmatism:** Lugard was severely understaffed and underfunded.
 2. **Pre-existing System:** The Sokoto Caliphate already had a highly sophisticated and centralized system of administration (Emirs, District Heads, Alkali courts, taxation) that was ready-made for the British to co-opt.
 3. **Minimizing Resistance:** It was easier to make the Emirs "partners" (even if junior partners) than to remove them and risk constant rebellion.
- **HOW IT WORKED:**
 - The Emir remained the head of his emirate. He kept his palace, his titles, and his court.
 - However, a British official, the "**Resident**," was posted in the emirate. The Resident was the *real* power, advising the Emir. The Emir's orders were, in fact, the Resident's orders.
 - The Emir's administration (the "Native Authority") was allowed to collect taxes, but a portion now went to the British.
 - The *Alkali* (Shari'a) courts were allowed to function, but they were forbidden from "inhuman" punishments (like mutilation).

3.4 CONSOLIDATION OF BRITISH AUTHORITY

By 1906, all of Northern Nigeria was under British control. In the same year, the **Lagos Colony** and the **Protectorate of Southern Nigeria** (the old Niger Coast Protectorate) were merged to form the new **Colony and Protectorate of Southern Nigeria**.

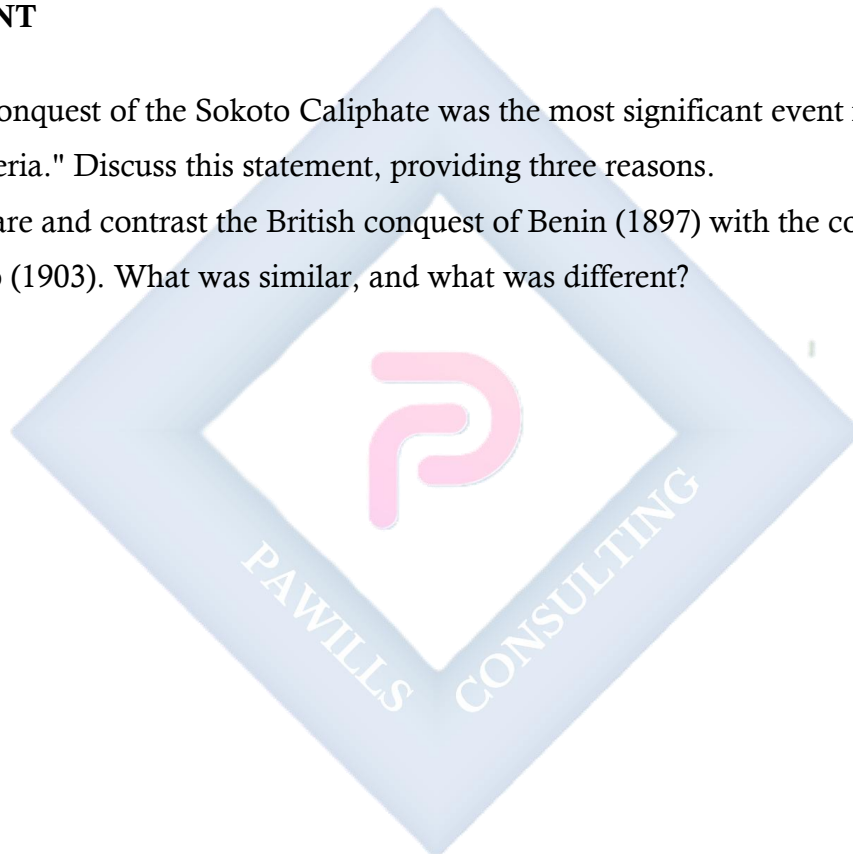
By 1914, Lugard had successfully conquered the North and consolidated the South. The stage was set for his final act: merging the two.

EVALUATION

1. Who was appointed the first High Commissioner of the Protectorate of Northern Nigeria in 1900?
2. What was the WAFF?
3. Who was the Caliph of Sokoto who resisted the British and was killed at the Battle of Burmi in 1903?
4. Define "Indirect Rule."
5. List two reasons why Lugard adopted the policy of Indirect Rule in Northern Nigeria.

ASSIGNMENT

1. "The conquest of the Sokoto Caliphate was the most significant event in the creation of Nigeria." Discuss this statement, providing three reasons.
2. Compare and contrast the British conquest of Benin (1897) with the conquest of Sokoto (1903). What was similar, and what was different?



WEEK 4: EARLY PHASE OF BRITISH RULE (1900–1914)

4.1 INTRODUCTION

This period covers the time *after* the main conquests but *before* the 1914 Amalgamation. During this time, the British had to figure out how to *govern* the vast and diverse territories they had seized. This led to the development of different administrative systems in the North and South.



4.2 ADMINISTRATION: THE THREE (THEN TWO) NIGERIAS

Between 1900 and 1906, British Nigeria was three separate entities:

1. **The Lagos Colony**
2. **The Protectorate of Southern Nigeria**
3. **The Protectorate of Northern Nigeria**

In 1906, Lagos and the Southern Protectorate were merged, simplifying this to two large blocs:

1. **The Colony and Protectorate of Southern Nigeria** (Governor: Walter Egerton)
2. **The ProtectorATE OF Northern Nigeria** (High Commissioner: Lord Lugard)

These two territories were run completely separately, with different governors, policies, legal systems, and budgets.

4.3 POLICIES AND NATIVE AUTHORITIES

- **IN THE NORTH (LUGARD):**

- **Policy:** Indirect Rule, as discussed last week.
- **Native Authorities (NAs):** The administration of the Emirs was formalized into the "**Native Authority.**" The NA was responsible for local government, police, courts, and tax collection. The British Resident simply supervised. This system was very successful *on its own terms* because it was cheap, efficient, and maintained order.
- **Policy on Missionaries:** Lugard *forbade* Christian missionaries from operating in the Muslim Emirates, fearing their presence would anger the Emirs and destabilize the indirect rule system. This had a monumental long-term effect on Western education in the North.

- **IN THE SOUTH (EGERTON):**

- **The West (Yorubaland):** The British tried to apply "indirect rule" using the Obas (like the Alaafin of Oyo and Ooni of Ife). This was moderately successful, as the Yoruba had a tradition of centralized monarchies.
- **The East (Igboland and environs):** Indirect rule was a *complete failure*. Igbo society was "acephalous," meaning it had no single king or central chief. It was governed by councils of elders, age-grades, and title-holders in autonomous villages.
- **The "Warrant Chief" System:** Since there were no chiefs to rule through, the British *created* them. They issued "warrants" to local men who seemed

influential, making them "Warrant Chiefs" and giving them power they never had traditionally. This policy was deeply resented, and the Warrant Chiefs were often seen as corrupt and illegitimate puppets.

4.4 TAXATION

Taxation was the primary reason for colonial rule: a colony had to pay for its own administration.

- **IN THE NORTH:** This was easy for Lugard. The Sokoto Caliphate already had a sophisticated tax system (*zakat, jangali, jizya*). Lugard simply "regularized" this system, taking a share for the British government.
- **IN THE SOUTH:** This was extremely difficult and unpopular. Most societies in the South did not have a tradition of direct taxation. The British imposition of direct taxes (like the "Hut Tax") was met with intense resistance and evasion. It was this attempt to tax, especially women, that would later lead to the **Aba Women's Riots of 1929**.

This period (1900-1914) entrenched a deep division in Nigeria: a Northern system based on traditional emirs and Islamic law, and a Southern system based on a mix of co-opted Obas, artificial Warrant Chiefs, and direct British rule, with a heavy Christian missionary (and thus, educational) presence.

EVALUATION

1. What two territories were merged in 1906 to create the "Colony and Protectorate of Southern Nigeria"?
2. What was the "Warrant Chief" system, and why was it introduced in Eastern Nigeria?
3. Why did Lugard forbid Christian missionaries from operating in the Muslim Emirates of the North?
4. Why was collecting tax easier for the British in the North than in the South?
5. What does the term "acephalous" mean in relation to Igbo society?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Write a detailed paragraph comparing the application of British administrative policy in Northern Nigeria and Eastern Nigeria between 1900 and 1914.
2. "The British policies on education and administration in this period created two different 'Nigerias' long before 1914." Discuss this statement.



WEEK 5: MIDTERM EXAMINATION

(This week is for examinations based on the content from Weeks 1-4. No new lesson notes.)



WEEK 6: THE AMALGAMATION OF NIGERIA (1914) AND ITS SIGNIFICANCE

6.1 INTRODUCTION

On **January 1, 1914**, the British formally merged the Protectorate of Northern Nigeria and the Colony and Protectorate of Southern Nigeria into a single entity called the **Colony and Protectorate of Nigeria**. This singular event is the origin of the modern Nigerian state. The architect of this policy was **Lord Frederick Lugard**, who returned to Nigeria and became its first Governor-General.



6.2 REASONS FOR AMALGAMATION

The merging of these two vast, different territories was done for British convenience, not for the benefit of the people living there. The reasons were primarily economic and administrative.

1. THE ECONOMIC IMPERATIVE (THE PRIMARY REASON):

- **The North was Broke:** The Protectorate of Northern Nigeria was a massive financial failure. It was landlocked, had high administrative costs (due to its size and military presence), and its main exports (groundnuts) were not yet profitable enough to pay its bills. It was surviving on an annual grant-in-aid (a bailout) from the British Treasury.
- **The South was Rich:** The Colony and Protectorate of Southern Nigeria was a huge financial success. Its coastal ports (Lagos, Calabar) generated massive revenue from customs duties on imported goods (like alcohol and tobacco). Its palm oil and cocoa exports were highly profitable.
- **The "Marriage":** The British Treasury in London was tired of bailing out the North. The simplest solution was to "amalgamate" the two budgets, using the South's surplus to pay for the North's deficit.

2. ADMINISTRATIVE CONVENIENCE:

- It was illogical and inefficient to run two separate administrations in neighboring territories.
- They had different policies, different judicial systems, and even different railway gauges.
- A single, unified administration would be easier and cheaper to manage from the Colonial Office in London.

3. INFRASTRUCTURE COORDINATION:

- A single, unified railway policy was needed. The British wanted to build a railway line from the coast (Lagos) to the deep interior (Kano) to evacuate cash crops (like groundnuts and cotton) and move troops. This required a single, unified government to oversee.

6.3 LORD LUGARD'S POLICY

Lugard's vision for the amalgamated Nigeria was to extend his "Indirect Rule" system, which he perfected in the North, over the entire country.

- He created a central government in Lagos, but he divided the country into two "Lieutenant-Governorships" (North and South).
- He made little effort to *unify* the people. The North and South were still governed as separate entities.
- He tried to force the "Warrant Chief" system (an imitation of the Northern model) onto the East, and tried to strengthen the Obas in the West, with mixed results.

6.4 SIGNIFICANCE: ADVANTAGES AND DISADVANTAGES

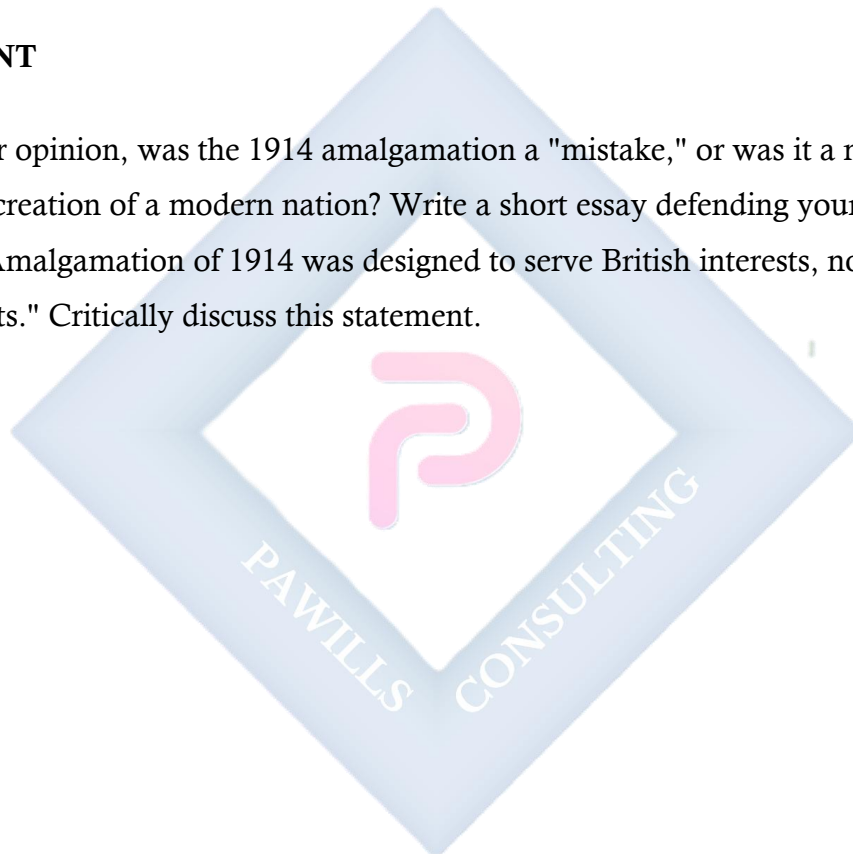
- **ADVANTAGES (FROM THE BRITISH PERSPECTIVE):**
 1. **Solved the Budget Crisis:** The South's revenue now paid for the North's administration.
 2. **Administrative Efficiency:** Created a single, large, and viable colonial territory.
 3. **Economic Integration:** Allowed for the creation of a national infrastructure (especially railways) to maximize resource extraction.
- **DISADVANTAGES (FROM THE NIGERIAN PERSPECTIVE):**
 1. **A "FORCED MARRIAGE":** The amalgamation was done with **zero consultation**. Over 250 distinct ethnic and political groups were forced into a single state.
 2. **SOWED SEEDS OF DIVISION:** Rather than encouraging unity, the British policy of governing the North and South differently *entrenched* their differences. This created the North-South political divide that has defined Nigerian history.
 3. **REGIONAL IMBALANCES:** The policy preserved the feudal, conservative structure of the North while the South was rapidly changing due to Western education and missionary activity. This created a deep social, political, and educational imbalance between the regions.
 4. **A MARRIAGE OF "UNEQUALS":** The amalgamation is often described as the "mistake of 1914," a marriage of "incompatible partners" that laid the groundwork for future political instability, competition, and conflict.

EVALUATION

1. What was the exact date of the Amalgamation of Nigeria?
2. Who was the British official responsible for the amalgamation, and what title did he take?
3. What was the *primary* economic reason for the amalgamation?
4. What was the "budgetary problem" that amalgamation solved?
5. List two major disadvantages of the amalgamation from a Nigerian perspective.

ASSIGNMENT

1. In your opinion, was the 1914 amalgamation a "mistake," or was it a necessary step in the creation of a modern nation? Write a short essay defending your position.
2. "The Amalgamation of 1914 was designed to serve British interests, not Nigerian interests." Critically discuss this statement.



WEEK 7: MIDTERM BREAK

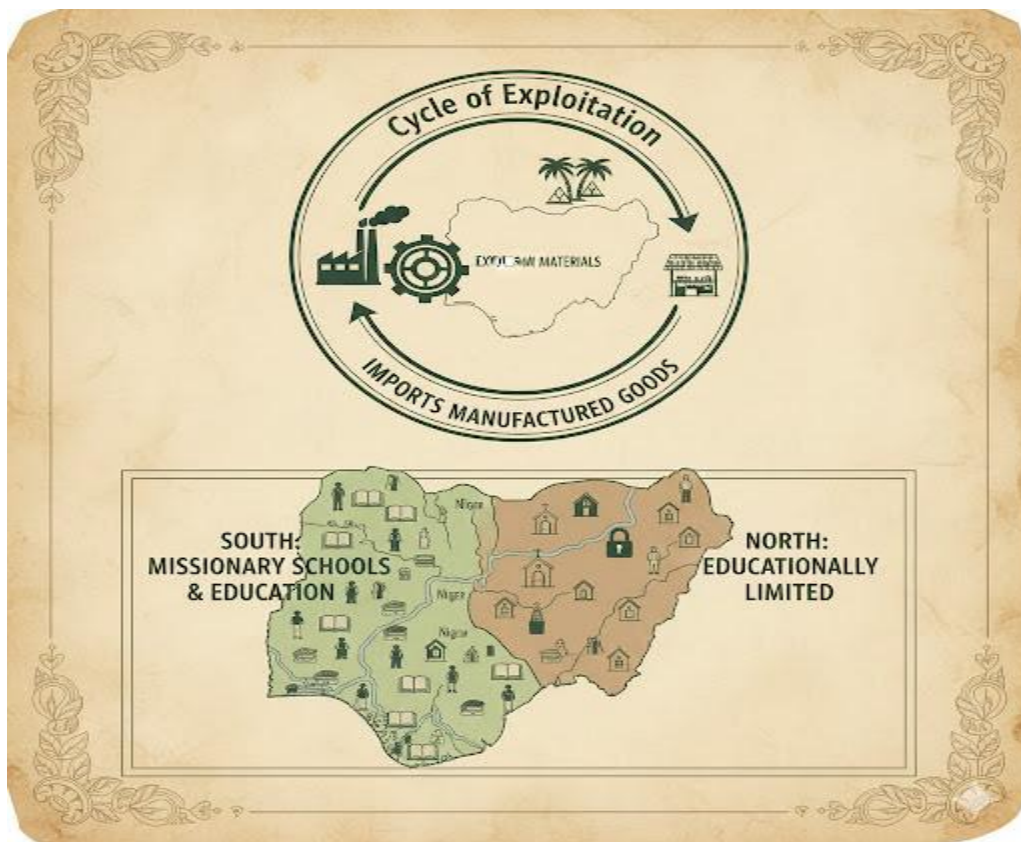
(This week is for a midterm break. No new lesson notes.)



WEEK 8: COLONIAL RULE AND ITS IMPACT

8.1 INTRODUCTION

Colonial rule was a total system. It was not just a political takeover; it was a fundamental re-engineering of Nigeria's economy, society, and culture to serve the interests of Great Britain. This week examines the key pillars of the colonial system and their impact.



8.2 CENTRAL ADMINISTRATION

After 1914, Nigeria was governed by a single **Governor-General** (later Governor) based in Lagos. He was a virtual dictator, responsible only to the Colonial Secretary in London.

- **THE NIGERIAN COUNCIL (LUGARD'S ERA):** Lugard created a council in 1914. It was a "talking shop" with no real power. It consisted of 36 members (mostly British officials and a few "traditional" rulers) who met once a year to listen to the Governor's speech.

- **THE CLIFFORD CONSTITUTION (1922):** This was Nigeria's first real constitution, introduced by Governor Sir Hugh Clifford.
 - It created a new **Legislative Council (LEGCO)**.
 - **Significance:** For the *first time in British West African history*, this council included **elected members**.
 - It allowed for 4 elected members: 3 from Lagos and 1 from Calabar.
 - This provision, though small, kick-started the development of political parties (like Herbert Macaulay's NNDP) and modern nationalist politics.
- **THE EXECUTIVE COUNCIL:** This was the Governor's "cabinet." It was composed entirely of British heads of departments (finance, military, health, etc.) and had the real power to run the country.

8.3 ECONOMIC EXPLOITATION

The *raison d'être* (reason for being) of the colony was profit. The colonial economy was a classic "extractive" economy.

- **A "DEPENDENT ECONOMY":** Nigeria was forced into a dependent relationship with Britain.
 1. **EXPORT:** Nigeria's role was to produce and export *raw materials* (palm oil, cocoa, cotton, tin, groundnuts) needed by British factories.
 2. **IMPORT:** Nigeria was then forced to *import* expensive, finished *manufactured goods* (like textiles, bicycles, and soap) *from* Britain.
- **SUPPRESSION OF LOCAL INDUSTRIES:** This system actively destroyed local industries. For example, Nigerian textile weavers could not compete with cheap, mass-produced cloth from Manchester. Local gin production was banned to create a market for British gin.
- **THE ROLE OF OLIGOPOLIES:** The entire import-export trade was monopolized by a few giant British firms, most notably the **United African Company (UAC)**, which was the successor to the Royal Niger Company. These firms fixed low prices for Nigerian farmers' crops and high prices for imported goods, draining wealth from the country.

8.4 INTRODUCTION OF WESTERN EDUCATION AND CHRISTIANITY

These two forces were the most powerful agents of social change, and they were almost inseparable.

- **LED BY MISSIONARIES:** Colonial policy in the South (especially) left education almost entirely in the hands of Christian missionary societies:
 - **CMS (Anglican)**
 - **Roman Catholics (Holy Ghost Fathers)**
 - **Methodists, Baptists, and Church of Scotland**
- **THEIR GOALS:** The primary goal of the missionaries was evangelization (spreading Christianity). They built schools as their main tool for conversion.
- **IMPACT IN THE SOUTH (YORUBALAND AND IGBOLAND):**
 - There was a massive, enthusiastic adoption of both Christianity and Western education.
 - It created a new, educated elite who became clerks, teachers, lawyers, doctors, and (most importantly) *nationalists*.
 - It also undermined traditional culture, religion, and the authority of elders.
- **IMPACT IN THE NORTH (HAUSA-FULANI EMIRATES):**
 - As part of the "Indirect Rule" bargain, Lugard *banned* Christian missionaries from the Muslim emirates.
 - The British government itself provided very little education (a few "secular" schools, like Katsina College, were set up to train the sons of the aristocracy to be "Native Authority" administrators).
 - **Result:** A vast **educational gap** was created between the North and the South, which became a major source of political imbalance and suspicion.

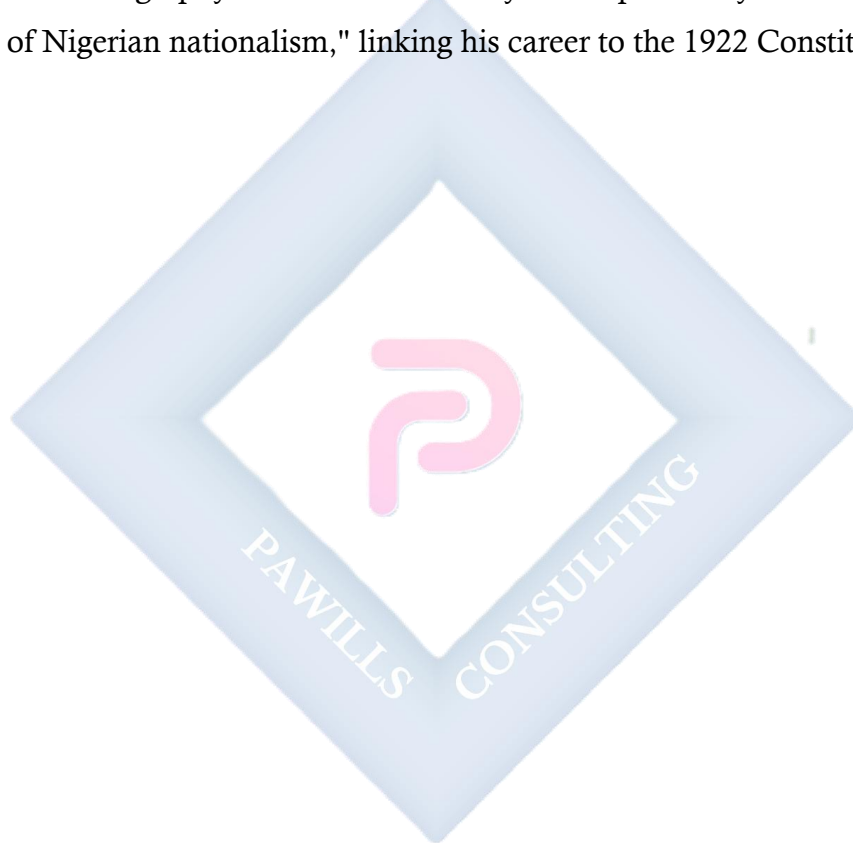
EVALUATION

1. What was the significance of the 1922 Clifford Constitution?
2. Explain the "extractive" or "dependent" model of the colonial economy.
3. What was the UAC, and what was its role in the colonial economy?

4. Why was Western education primarily led by missionaries in the South?
5. What was the main reason for the vast educational gap that emerged between the North and the South?

ASSIGNMENT

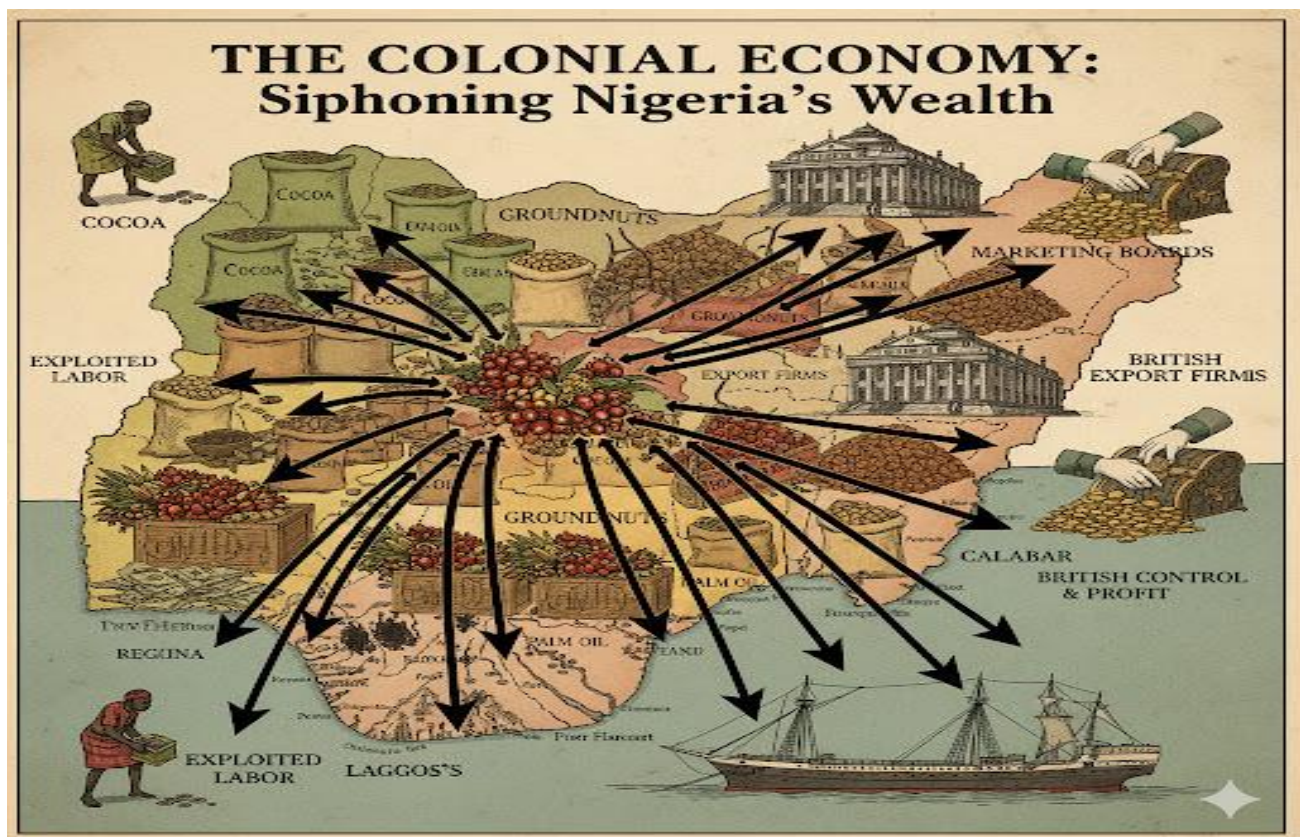
1. "Christian missionaries did more to create modern Nigeria than the colonial government." Discuss this statement, providing two points for and two points against.
2. Write a short biography of Herbert Macaulay and explain why he is often called the "father of Nigerian nationalism," linking his career to the 1922 Constitution.



WEEK 9: THE COLONIAL ECONOMY

9.1 INTRODUCTION

This week is a deeper dive into the specific mechanisms of the colonial economy discussed in Week 8. The goal was simple: extract the maximum amount of raw materials at the minimum cost and create a captive market for British goods.



9.2 CASH CROP PRODUCTION

This was the engine of the colonial economy. The British system encouraged (and often forced) farmers to shift from growing food for themselves (subsistence farming) to growing crops for export.

- **REGIONAL SPECIALIZATION:**

- **THE WEST:** Became the **Cocoa Belt**. Farmers in Yorubaland, responding to high prices, adopted cocoa cultivation on a massive scale.
- **THE EAST:** Became the **Palm Oil Belt**. Palm oil and palm kernels, which grew wild, were collected and processed for export.
- **THE NORTH:** Became the **Groundnut and Cotton Belt**. The railway to Kano (completed in 1911) made it possible to export groundnuts, leading to the famous "Groundnut Pyramids." Cotton was also pushed as a raw material for British textile mills.
- **IMPACT:**
 - **Pros:** It brought many Nigerians into the cash economy and created some wealth, especially for cocoa farmers and northern merchants.
 - **Cons:** It made the Nigerian economy a *monoculture* economy, vulnerable to price swings on the world market. It also reduced the amount of land and labor dedicated to food production, sometimes leading to local food shortages.

9.3 TAXATION

Taxation was the primary tool used to *force* Nigerians into the cash economy.

- **THE SYSTEM:** The British imposed taxes (like the "Hut Tax" or "Poll Tax") that had to be paid in **British currency** (pounds, shillings, and pence).
- **THE GOAL:** To get this currency, a farmer could no longer just grow his own yams. He had to:
 1. Grow a cash crop (cocoa, groundnuts) and sell it to the UAC.
 2. Leave his village to work as a laborer on the railways, in the tin mines (Jos), or as a clerk for the government.
- Taxation was, therefore, a tool of social engineering, designed to create a mobile, cash-dependent labor force for the colonial system.

9.4 INFRASTRUCTURE (RAILWAYS, PORTS, ROADS)

The British built significant infrastructure, which is often cited as a "benefit" of colonialism. However, the *design* of this infrastructure reveals its true purpose.

- **PURPOSE:** The infrastructure was built *only* to facilitate the extractive economy.
- **THE RAILWAY LINES:** The main railway lines did *not* connect major Nigerian population centers to each other. They ran from the *resource-producing interior* to the *coastal ports*.
 - The Western Line ran from **Lagos** to **Kano** (to get groundnuts and cotton).
 - The Eastern Line ran from **Port Harcourt** (a new port built by the British) to **Enugu** (to get coal) and later to Jos (to get tin).
- **THE PORTS:** Lagos (Apapa) and Port Harcourt were developed as major deep-water ports, not for Nigerian use, but for European ships to load raw materials and unload manufactured goods.
- **THE ROADS:** A network of "feeder roads" was built to connect the farms and mines to the railway stations.

9.5 TRADE

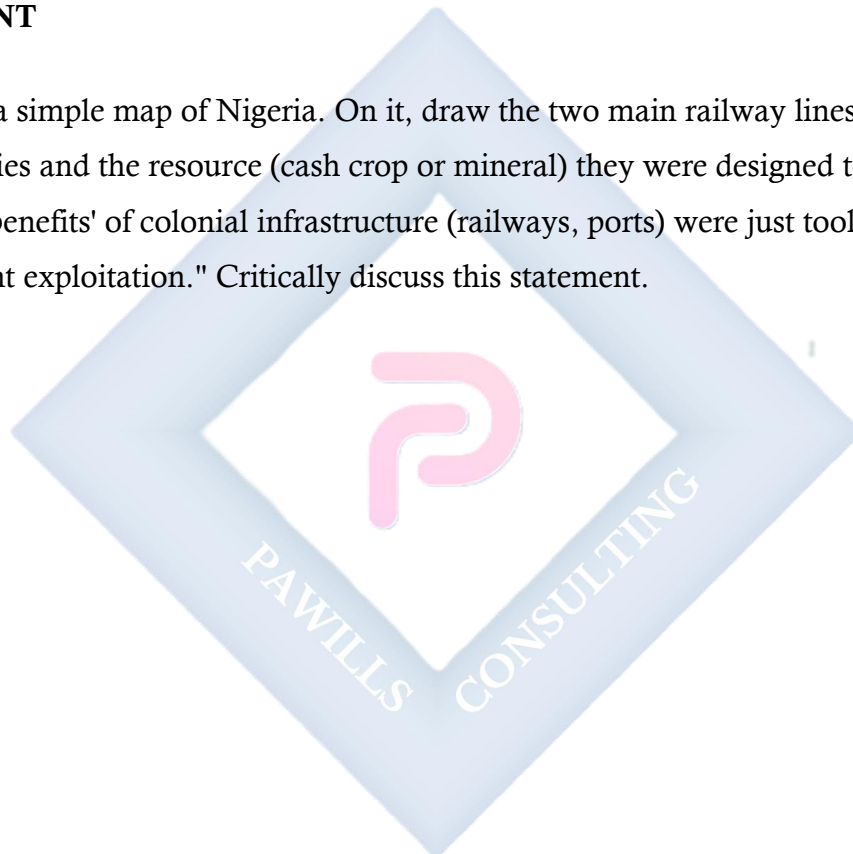
- **DOMINATED BY FOREIGN FIRMS:** As mentioned in Week 8, the entire import-export trade was monopolized by a few British firms (UAC, John Holt, G.B. Ollivant).
- **THE MARKETING BOARDS:** Later in the colonial period, the British created "Marketing Boards" (e.g., the Cocoa Marketing Board, the Groundnut Marketing Board).
 - **Stated Purpose:** To stabilize prices for farmers.
 - **Real Purpose:** To fix a very *low* price for farmers' crops, sell them on the world market for a *high* price, and keep the difference (the "surplus") in British banks. This was a form of systematic exploitation, draining billions from the Nigerian economy.

EVALUATION

1. What were the three main cash crops of the colonial economy, and which region did each come from?
2. What were the "Groundnut Pyramids"?
3. How did the colonial tax system force Nigerians to join the cash economy?
4. What was the main purpose of the colonial railway lines? Give an example of one major line.
5. What was a "Marketing Board," and how did it exploit Nigerian farmers?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Draw a simple map of Nigeria. On it, draw the two main railway lines and label the key cities and the resource (cash crop or mineral) they were designed to export.
2. "The 'benefits' of colonial infrastructure (railways, ports) were just tools for more efficient exploitation." Critically discuss this statement.



WEEK 10: SOCIAL DEVELOPMENT AND INTER-GROUP RELATIONS

10.1 INTRODUCTION

Colonialism was not just a political and economic project; it was a social one. It completely re-ordered Nigerian society, creating new cities, new social classes, and, for the first time, a sense of a common "Nigerian" identity.



10.2 URBANIZATION

Colonial rule led to the explosive growth of new cities, which were the administrative and commercial hubs of the new economy.

- **TRADITIONAL CITIES:** Pre-colonial cities like Ibadan, Kano, and Benin continued to be important.
- **NEW "COLONIAL" CITIES:** These cities were created *by* the British for specific purposes:
 - **Lagos:** Grew from a small port into the sprawling, multi-ethnic capital of the entire country.

- **Port Harcourt:** A port city built from scratch in 1912 to export coal from Enugu.
- **Enugu:** A city created in 1909 after coal was discovered there.
- **Kaduna:** A "neutral" city built by Lugard in 1912 to be the new capital of the North, away from the traditional power centers of Sokoto or Kano.
- **Jos:** Grew as the center of the tin mining industry.
- **IMPACT:** These new cities became "melting pots" where, for the first time, large numbers of Igbo, Yoruba, Hausa, Efik, and other groups lived and worked together. This mixing was essential for the development of a national identity.

10.3 MISSIONARY EDUCATION AND THE NEW ELITE

- **(Recap from Week 8):** Missionary education was the key to social mobility.
- **THE NEW SOCIAL CLASS:** The product of this education was a new social class that did not exist in traditional society: the **Western-educated elite**.
- **WHO THEY WERE:** This elite was made up of clerks, teachers, lawyers, doctors, journalists, and railway workers. They spoke English, wore European clothes, lived in the new urban centers, and were often Christian.
- **A "MIDDLE-MAN" CLASS:** They were suspended between two worlds: they were rejected by the British as "social equals" (kept out of the European clubs and senior government posts) but were also now different from their own people in the villages.
- **THEIR ROLE:** This new elite was the only group with the language (English) and the intellectual tools (Western political ideas of "liberty" and "self-determination") to challenge the British. **The colonial education system, by accident, created the very nationalists who would destroy it.**

10.4 NATIONAL CONSCIOUSNESS

- **THE IRONY OF COLONIALISM:** Colonialism, by forcing over 250 groups into a single country called "Nigeria," accidentally *created* Nigerian nationalism.
- **FACTORS THAT FORGED NATIONAL CONSCIOUSNESS:**

1. **A COMMON NAME:** The name "Nigeria" (coined by Flora Shaw) gave all groups a new, shared label.
 2. **A COMMON ENEMY:** All groups, regardless of their differences, shared a common experience of foreign, racist, and exploitative rule. This "common enemy" (the British) was a powerful unifying force.
 3. **A COMMON LANGUAGE:** English became the *lingua franca*, allowing a lawyer from Lagos (Yoruba) to communicate with a merchant from Onitsha (Igbo) and a teacher from Calabar (Efik).
 4. **SHARED SPACES:** The new cities, schools, and railways allowed people to mix and see themselves as part of something bigger than just their own ethnic group.
- **THE BIRTH OF NATIONALISM:** This new "national consciousness" first found its voice in the new elite. Men like **Herbert Macaulay** (the "father of Nigerian nationalism") began to demand not just better treatment, but political rights and, eventually, independence.

EVALUATION

1. Name two "new" cities created by the British and the economic reason for their creation.
2. Describe the "Western-educated elite." What jobs did they do?
3. Why was this new elite "suspended between two worlds"?
4. What is the "irony of colonialism" regarding Nigerian nationalism?
5. List three factors that helped create a common "national consciousness."

ASSIGNMENT

1. "Colonialism did not create Nigeria; it only created the tensions that would later divide it. Nigerian nationalism was created by Nigerians themselves." What is your view on this statement?
2. Write a short article for a 1920s Lagos newspaper, written by a member of the new educated elite, explaining your grievances against the colonial government.

WEEK 11: REVISION

(This week is dedicated to a comprehensive review of all topics covered during the second term. Students should review their notes from Weeks 1-10 in preparation for the Second Term Examination.)

- **KEY AREAS FOR REVIEW:**

- **Benin in the 19th Century:** Political structure (Oba, *Uzama*), trade (palm oil monopoly), and the conflict with Britain.
- **First Phase of Conquest (1851-1900):** The Lagos Bombardment (1851) and Annexation (1861); the Benin Punitive Expedition (1897) and the looting of the bronzes.
- **Second Phase of Conquest (1900-1914):** Lugard, the WAFF, and the conquest of the Sokoto Caliphate (Battle of Burmi, 1903).
- **Early British Rule:** Indirect Rule (North), the "Warrant Chief" system (East), and the differences in taxation and missionary policy.
- **Amalgamation of 1914:** The primary economic reasons (North's deficit, South's surplus) and the long-term disadvantages (forced marriage, regional imbalance).
- **Colonial Impact:** The "extractive" economy, the role of missionaries and Western education, and the massive educational gap.
- **Colonial Economy:** Cash crop specialization (cocoa, groundnuts, palm oil), the purpose of infrastructure (railways), and the exploitation by foreign firms (UAC).
- **Social Development:** The rise of new colonial cities (Lagos, Port Harcourt, Enugu) and the birth of national consciousness.

SS2 NIGERIAN HISTORY

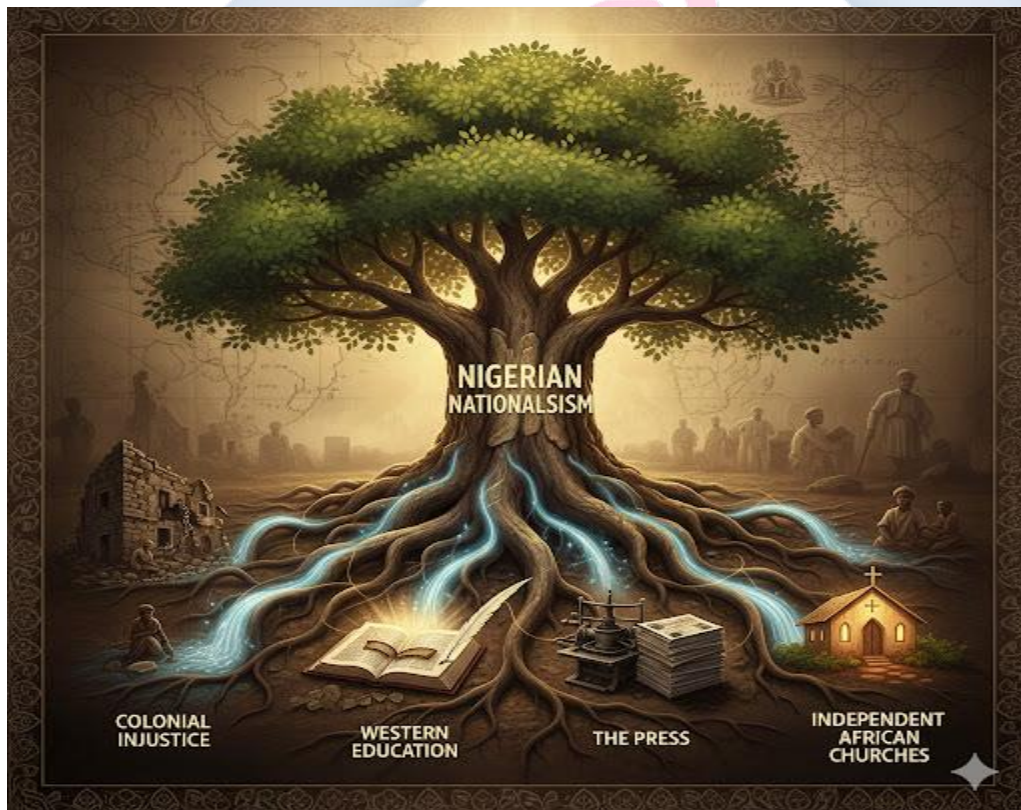
THIRD TERM LESSON NOTES

WEEK 1: ORIGINS OF NATIONALISM IN NIGERIA

1.1 INTRODUCTION: WHAT IS NATIONALISM?

NATIONALISM is the feeling of political consciousness or awareness among a group of people, who share a common territory and identity, that leads them to assert their right to self-government, free from foreign control.

In the Nigerian context, it was the movement and struggle led by an educated African elite to overthrow British colonial rule and establish a new, independent Nigerian nation. This movement began slowly with simple demands for better treatment and inclusion, and grew into an unstoppable demand for full independence.



1.2 CAUSES OF NATIONALISM IN NIGERIA

There was no single cause for nationalism. It was a complex reaction to the colonial experience itself.

1. COLONIAL POLICIES (THE "COMMON ENEMY"):

- **Political Exclusion:** Nigerians were completely excluded from any real position of power. The Governor and his Executive Council (all British) held dictatorial power. The Legislative Council was merely a "talking shop." This exclusion angered the new educated elite who felt qualified to rule.
- **Economic Exploitation:** The colonial economy was designed to exploit Nigeria.
 - *The Marketing Boards* paid Nigerian farmers low, fixed prices for their cash crops (cocoa, palm oil, groundnuts) and sold them on the world market for a huge profit, which was kept in Britain.
 - *Foreign Firms*, especially the **United African Company (UAC)**, monopolized the import-export trade, stifling Nigerian businesses.
 - *Direct Taxation* (like the poll tax) was imposed on people, forcing them into the cash economy.
- **Social Segregation and Racism:** Colonial society was deeply racist.
 - Europeans lived in "European Quarters" (e.g., Ikoyi in Lagos, the GRA - Government Reserved Area - in other cities) with separate hospitals, clubs, and schools.
 - Nigerians, no matter how educated or wealthy, were treated as inferior. A Nigerian lawyer or doctor was still considered "junior" to the lowest British colonial official.
- This shared experience of being ruled by a common, racist, and exploitative foreign power (Britain) was the single most powerful factor in uniting diverse groups as "Nigerians."

2. WESTERN EDUCATION:

- **The "Accidental" Tool:** The colonialists (especially missionaries) introduced Western education to produce clerks, interpreters, and teachers for the colonial administration.
- **Ideas of Freedom:** However, this education exposed Nigerians to Western political ideas of "Liberty," "Democracy," "Self-Determination," and "Nationalism." Nigerians read about the American and French Revolutions and began to ask, "Why can't we rule ourselves?"
- **A New Elite:** Education created a new, confident class of lawyers, doctors, journalists, and teachers (the "nationalist elite") who had the intellectual tools to challenge colonialism.
- **A Common Language:** English became the *lingua franca*, allowing the elite from different ethnic groups (Yoruba, Igbo, Efik, etc.) to communicate and organize a national movement.

3. THE PRESS:

- The educated elite founded newspapers that became the mouthpiece of nationalism.
- These newspapers exposed colonial injustices, criticized government policies, and spread nationalist ideas to the literate population in the growing cities.
- **Key Newspapers:**
 - *The Lagos Weekly Record* (John Payne Jackson)
 - *West African Pilot* (founded by Nnamdi Azikiwe in 1937), which had the famous motto: "Show the light, and the people will find the way."

4. RELIGION (THE "ETHIOPIAN" MOVEMENT):

- Many Nigerian Christians in European-led churches (Anglican, Methodist, Catholic) grew frustrated with the racism and discrimination they faced. European missionaries dominated the leadership and were often as condescending as colonial officials.
- This led to a "schism," where Nigerians broke away to form their own "**African Independent Churches.**"

- This was a form of "religious nationalism"—an early demand for "self-government" in the church. It showed that Africans were capable of managing their own affairs without European supervision.

EVALUATION

1. Define "Nationalism" in the Nigerian context.
2. Explain how Western education, a tool of the colonizers, accidentally fueled nationalism.
3. What was the role of the "Marketing Boards" in the colonial economy?
4. Who was Nnamdi Azikiwe, and what was the name of his famous newspaper?
5. What was the "Ethiopian" movement, and what did it represent?

ASSIGNMENT

1. "The strongest force that created Nigerian nationalism was not a love for 'Nigeria,' but a shared hatred of the British colonial system." Do you agree? Provide three reasons for your answer.
2. Imagine you are a Nigerian trader in 1930. Write a short letter to the editor of the *West African Pilot* complaining about the economic policies of the colonial government.

WEEK 2: NATIONALIST MOVEMENTS AFTER WORLD WAR II



2.1 THE IMPACT OF WORLD WAR II

World War II (1939–1945) was the single greatest catalyst for the acceleration of nationalism.

1. **Demobilized Soldiers ("Ex-Servicemen"):** Thousands of Nigerian soldiers fought for Britain in Burma, India, and East Africa.
 - They saw European soldiers (British, French) as equals, not "gods."
 - They fought for "freedom" and "democracy," and when they returned, they demanded those same rights for themselves.
 - They became the militant, organized backbone of the nationalist movement.

2. **The Atlantic Charter (1941):** This was a joint declaration by US President Roosevelt and British Prime Minister Churchill. It stated that all peoples had the "**right to self-determination**" (the right to choose their own form of government).
 - Although Churchill later claimed this only applied to European nations under Nazi rule, Nigerian nationalists seized on it and used it as a moral and legal argument against colonialism.
3. **Weakening of Britain:** The war exhausted Britain, leaving it financially broke and militarily weak. It no longer had the money or the will to maintain a vast, unwilling empire.

2.2 POLITICAL ORGANIZATIONS (THE "BIG THREE" PARTIES)

The post-WWII era saw the decline of early nationalist "movements" (like the West African Students' Union) and the rise of mass political parties. These parties, however, became increasingly regional, a fact that would define Nigeria's political future.

1. NCNC (NATIONAL COUNCIL OF NIGERIA AND THE CAMEROONS):

- **Founded:** 1944.
- **Founders:** Herbert Macaulay (first President) and Nnamdi Azikiwe (first Secretary-General, who took over as leader after Macaulay's death in 1946).
- **Initial Goal:** To be a pan-Nigerian, national party to fight for independence. It was the first "truly" national party.
- **Base of Support:** Its initial base was broad, but as regionalism grew, it became increasingly associated with the **Igbo people and the Eastern Region**.
- **Key Policy:** A strong, unified Nigeria; immediate independence.

2. AG (ACTION GROUP):

- **Founded:** 1951.
- **Founder:** Chief Obafemi Awolowo.
- **Origin:** The AG was formed from a Yoruba cultural organization called the *Egbe Omo Oduduwa* ("Society of the Descendants of Oduduwa").

- **Base of Support:** Overwhelmingly based in the **Yoruba-dominated Western Region**.
- **Key Policy:** Independence, but under a **federal system** ("federalism"). The AG believed that a federal structure, where each region had autonomy, was the only way to protect the unique cultures and interests of Nigeria's diverse ethnic groups.

3. NPC (NORTHERN PEOPLE'S CONGRESS):

- **Founded:** 1951.
- **Founder:** Sir Ahmadu Bello, the *Sardauna* of Sokoto (Party Leader), with Sir Abubakar Tafawa Balewa as his deputy (and the party's leader in Lagos).
- **Origin:** It began as a Northern cultural organization, *Jam'iyyar Mutanen Arewa*.
- **Base of Support:** Exclusively based in the **Hausa-Fulani-dominated Northern Region**.
- **Key Policy:** Its primary goal was *not* independence. Its motto was "One North, One People." The NPC's priority was to protect the Northern traditional, political, and religious systems (the emirates) from being dominated by the more educated South. They feared that if independence came too quickly ("Independence in 1956"), Southerners would take over the civil service.

4. OTHERS (NEPU):

- **NORTHERN ELEMENTS PROGRESSIVE UNION (NEPU):** Founded by **Aminu Kano**.
- **Goal:** A radical, populist party in the North. It was opposed to the NPC, which it saw as a party of the feudal, conservative aristocracy (the Emirs). NEPU represented the *talakawa* (commoners) of the North.

EVALUATION

1. State two ways World War II accelerated nationalism in Nigeria.
2. What was the "Atlantic Charter," and why was it important?
3. Who was the founder of the Action Group (AG), and what was its main base of support?

4. What was the main political goal of the NPC, and what was its famous motto?
5. How was Aminu Kano's NEPU different from Ahmadu Bello's NPC?

ASSIGNMENT

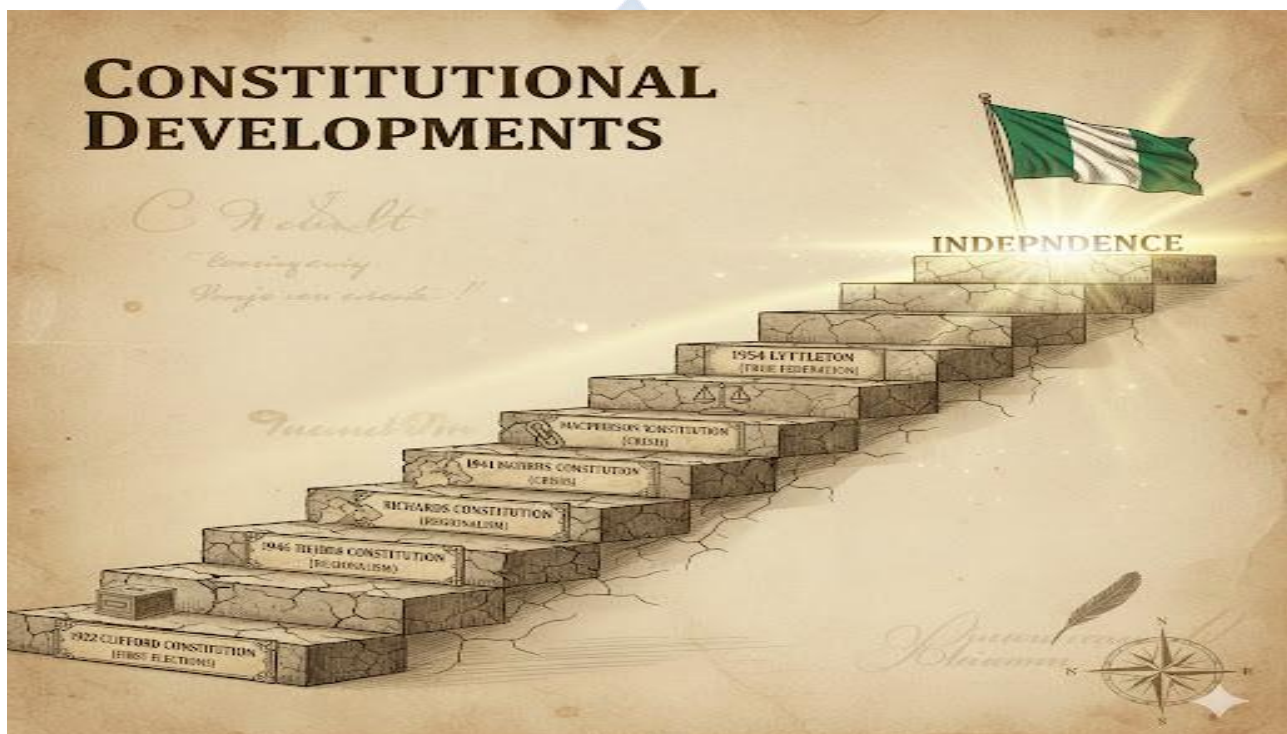
1. Compare and contrast the NCNC, AG, and NPC in a table. Include columns for: Leader, Region, and Main Policy Goal.
2. "The Nigerian political parties that fought for independence were the ones that laid the foundation for Nigeria's future disunity." Do you agree? Explain your reasoning.



WEEK 3: THE ROAD TO INDEPENDENCE (CONSTITUTIONAL DEVELOPMENTS)

3.1 INTRODUCTION

The story of Nigeria's journey to independence is a story of constitutional development. Each new constitution was a "test" by the British and a reaction to nationalist demands. Each one conceded more power to Nigerians until full independence was achieved.



3.2 THE CLIFFORD CONSTITUTION (1922)

- **Governor:** Sir Hugh Clifford.
- **Key Feature (The Elective Principle):** This was the *first* time in Nigerian history that any form of election was allowed. It created a Legislative Council (LEGCO) that included **4 elected members** (3 from Lagos, 1 from Calabar).
- **Major Flaw:**

1. **Divisive:** The LEGCO only made laws for the South. The Governor continued to rule the North by proclamation (like a dictator). This *legally* separated the North and South.
2. **Powerless:** The council was dominated by British officials. The elected members were a tiny minority who could be (and were) ignored.
- **Significance:** Its "elective principle" kick-started modern politics and led to the formation of the first political party, Herbert Macaulay's **Nigerian National Democratic Party (NNDP)**.

3.3 THE RICHARDS CONSTITUTION (1946)

- **Governor:** Sir Arthur Richards.
- **Context:** A response to post-WWII agitation and the growing influence of the NCNC.
- **Key Features:**
 1. **Unity (on paper):** It created a *single* Legislative Council for the *entire* country (North and South) for the first time.
 2. **Regionalism (in practice):** This was its most important feature. It formally divided Nigeria into **Three Regions** (North, West, and East) and created a "House of Assembly" for each.
- **Major Flaw (Imposition):** The constitution was created with **zero consultation** from Nigerians. It was simply imposed by the Governor.
- **Significance:**
 1. It infuriated the nationalists. The NCNC, led by Azikiwe, launched a pan-Nigeria tour to protest it and even sent a delegation to London.
 2. By formally creating the "three-region" structure, it *entrenched* regionalism and ethnicity as the basis of Nigerian politics.

3.4 THE MACPHERSON CONSTITUTION (1951)

- **Governor:** Sir John Macpherson.

- **Context:** A direct response to the failure and protests against the Richards Constitution.
- **Key Features (Consultation):** This was Nigeria's first "home-grown" constitution. A massive, nation-wide consultation was held, from the village level up to a national conference.
- **Political Features:**
 1. **Stronger Regions:** It created much more powerful Regional Assemblies with true legislative powers.
 2. **Central Legislature:** A central "House of Representatives" was created with members elected *from* the Regional Houses.
 3. **Ministers:** For the first time, Nigerians were appointed as **Ministers** in the central government, creating a "Council of Ministers."
- **Major Flaw (Died on Arrival):** The constitution was a compromise that satisfied no one. It was unclear if Nigeria was a unitary or federal state. It led to a major crisis in 1953.
 - **The 1953 Motion Crisis:** An Action Group member, **Anthony Enahoro**, moved a motion for "self-government in 1956." The Northern leaders (NPC) felt this was too soon and were booed by the Lagos crowd. This led to the **Kano Riots** of 1953 and a breakdown of trust. The North threatened to secede.

3.5 THE LYTTLETON CONSTITUTION (1954)

- **Governor:** Sir Oliver Lyttleton.
- **Context:** An emergency constitution to fix the 1953 crisis and save Nigeria from breaking apart.
- **Key Features (True Federalism):** This is the constitution that defined modern Nigeria.
 1. **A True Federation:** It *officially* established Nigeria as a **Federation** of three autonomous regions.
 2. **Division of Powers:** It created clear lists of powers:

- **Exclusive List:** Powers for the *Federal* (central) government only (e.g., army, currency, foreign policy).
 - **Concurrent List:** Powers shared by *Federal and Regional* governments (e.g., health, education).
 - **Residual List:** Powers for the *Regions* only.
3. **Regional Autonomy:** The Regions became fully autonomous. For the first time, leaders of the majority parties in the regions were named "**Premiers**" (Ahmadu Bello in the North, Awolowo in the West, Azikiwe in the East).

EVALUATION

1. What was the "elective principle," and which constitution introduced it?
2. What was the main flaw of the 1946 Richards Constitution that led to nationalist protests?
3. Why was the 1951 Macpherson Constitution considered "home-grown"?
4. What was the 1953 "Motion for Self-Government," and who moved it?
5. What was the most important achievement of the 1954 Lyttleton Constitution?

ASSIGNMENT

1. "The Richards Constitution of 1946 did more to divide Nigeria than the Clifford Constitution of 1922." Discuss this statement, providing two clear arguments.
2. Create a timeline showing the four constitutions. For each, list its year and its *one* most important new feature.

WEEK 4: THE ATTAINMENT OF INDEPENDENCE (1960)

4.1 NATIONALIST LEADERS

By the late 1950s, the struggle for independence was dominated by the leaders of the "Big Three" regional parties. These were the "Founding Fathers" of Nigeria.



1. SIR AHMADU BELLO (NPC):

- The *Sardauna* of Sokoto. A descendant of Usman dan Fodio.
- Leader of the NPC and **Premier of the Northern Region.**
- He was the most powerful politician in Nigeria but chose to stay in the North, sending his deputy to be Prime Minister in Lagos.

2. CHIEF OBAFEMI AWOLOWO (AG):

- Leader of the Action Group and **Premier of the Western Region.**
- A brilliant intellectual and administrator, known for his "federalist" policies and the UPE (Universal Primary Education) scheme.

3. DR. NNAMDI AZIKIWE (NCNC):

- Leader of the NCNC and **Premier of the Eastern Region.**
- Known as "Zik," he was a charismatic journalist and the first truly "national" figure of the independence movement.

4. **SIR ABUBAKAR TAFAWA BALEWA (NPC):**

- The Deputy Leader of the NPC.
- He was the NPC's parliamentary leader in Lagos and became Nigeria's first (and only) **Prime Minister.**

4.2 FINAL EVENTS LEADING TO INDEPENDENCE

1. **Constitutional Conferences (1957 & 1958):**

- Nigerian leaders (Awo, Zik, Bello) met with the British in London to negotiate the final steps.
- **1957:** The Eastern and Western Regions were granted full **internal self-government.**
- **1958:** The Northern Region was granted internal self-government.
- **The Willink Commission (1958):** The British set up a commission to address the deep-seated **fears of the ethnic minorities** (e.g., the Tiv in the North, the Efik/Ibibio in the East, the Urhobo/Edo in the West) who were afraid of being dominated by the "Big Three" (Hausa-Fulani, Igbo, Yoruba). The Commission found these fears were genuine but decided *not* to create new states, believing other "human rights" clauses would protect them. This was a fatal error.
- **Independence Date:** An official independence date was set for **October 1, 1960.**

2. **The 1959 Federal Election:**

- This was the election to decide which party would rule the newly independent Nigeria.
- **Results:**
 - **NPC (North):** Won the most seats (134), but *not* an outright majority.
 - **NCNC (East):** Won 89 seats.

- **AG (West):** Won 73 seats.
- **The Coalition:** No party could rule alone. The NPC formed a **coalition government with the NCNC.**
- **The New Government (1960):**
 - **Prime Minister:** Sir Abubakar Tafawa Balewa (NPC)
 - **Governor-General:** Dr. Nnamdi Azikiwe (NCNC) (representing the Queen)
 - **Leader of the Opposition:** Chief Obafemi Awolowo (AG)

4.3 INDEPENDENCE DAY (OCTOBER 1, 1960)

On this day, the Union Jack (British flag) was lowered, and the new Nigerian flag was raised at Tafawa Balewa Square in Lagos. After nearly 100 years of British presence and 60 years of direct colonial rule, Nigeria became a sovereign, independent state (a "Dominion" within the British Commonwealth).

4.4 IMMEDIATE CHALLENGES OF SELF-GOVERNMENT

Independence was celebrated with great joy, but the new nation faced enormous, unsolved problems from day one.

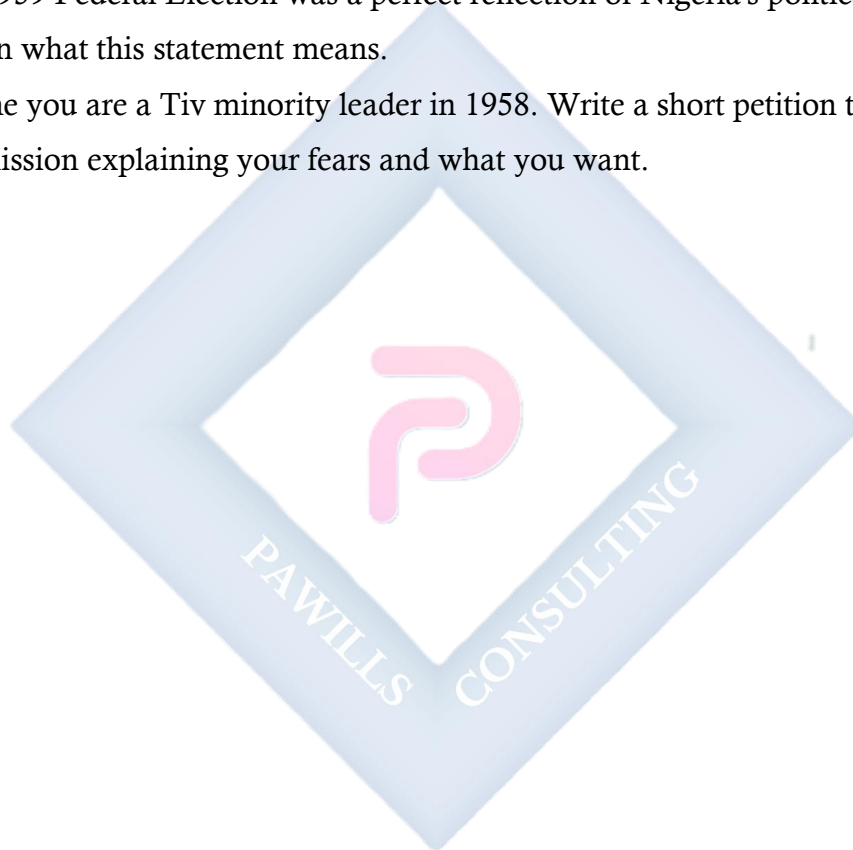
1. **DEEP ETHNIC AND REGIONAL DIVISION:** Loyalty was to the Region (and ethnic group), not to the "Nation." The parties were regional, not national.
2. **THE MINORITY PROBLEM:** The fears of the minorities had not been solved. This would lead to unrest (e.g., the Tiv Riots).
3. **EDUCATIONAL IMBALANCE:** The South (especially the West) was decades ahead of the North in Western education. The North feared the "Southern domination" of the federal civil service.
4. **WEAK NATIONAL IDENTITY:** The "unity" that existed was largely a product of the shared fight against the British. With the common enemy gone, the deep cracks in the foundation of Nigeria became immediately apparent.

EVALUATION

1. Name the "Big Three" nationalist leaders and the region each governed as Premier.
2. Who became Nigeria's first Prime Minister, and to what party did he belong?
3. Who became the Leader of the Opposition?
4. What was the "Willink Commission," and what did it investigate?
5. List three major challenges facing Nigeria at independence in 1960.

ASSIGNMENT

1. "The 1959 Federal Election was a perfect reflection of Nigeria's political problems."
Explain what this statement means.
2. Imagine you are a Tiv minority leader in 1958. Write a short petition to the Willink Commission explaining your fears and what you want.



WEEK 5: MIDTERM EXAMINATION

(This week is for examinations based on the content from Weeks 1-4. No new lesson notes.)



WEEK 6: THE FIRST REPUBLIC (1960–1966)

6.1 INTRODUCTION

The **First Republic** refers to the period from October 1, 1960, to January 15, 1966. It began with Nigeria as a "Dominion" (with the Queen of England as Head of State) and became a full **Republic** on **October 1, 1963**. This meant the Governor-General (Dr. Azikiwe) became the **President** (a ceremonial role). The Prime Minister (Tafawa Balewa) still held the real political power.

This period was marked by high hopes, but it was dominated by political instability, bitter regionalism, and a series of crises that ultimately destroyed the republic.



6.2 POLITICAL PARTIES AND REGIONALISM

The political structure was the same as at independence:

- **Federal Government:** A shaky coalition of the **NPC (North)** and the **NCNC (East)**.

- **Opposition:** The **AG (West)**.

The primary problem was that the NPC, due to the North's massive population, had a near-permanent hold on federal power. The other parties, particularly the AG, felt locked out.

6.3 MAJOR CRISES OF THE FIRST REPUBLIC

The First Republic was destroyed by five (5) major, interlocking crises.

1. THE ACTION GROUP (AG) CRISIS (1962):

- A "personality clash" and power struggle erupted within the AG, the ruling party in the West.
- The split was between **Chief Obafemi Awolowo** (Party Leader) and **Chief S.L. Akintola** (Premier of the West).
- The conflict turned violent, with supporters of both men fighting on the floor of the Western House of Assembly.
- **Federal Intervention:** The NPC-NCNC federal government saw its chance to destroy its main rival. It declared a "**State of Emergency**" in the West, dissolved the regional government, and appointed a Federal Administrator to rule the region.

2. THE TREASONABLE FELONY TRIAL (1963):

- Following the AG crisis, Chief Awolowo and several of his key allies were arrested.
- They were charged with "treasonable felony"—plotting to overthrow the federal government by force.
- After a highly controversial trial, Awolowo was found guilty and sentenced to 10 years in prison.
- **Impact:** This was seen by many Yorubas as a political witch-hunt by the North (NPC) to jail the main leader of the opposition. It was a massive blow to national unity.

3. THE CENSUS CRISIS (1962–1963):

- In Nigeria, population *is* power (it determines how many seats each region gets in parliament).
- The 1962 census was held. The results, which were leaked, showed that the **South (East + West) had more people than the North.**
- This was politically explosive, as it would mean the North would lose its majority in parliament.
- The NPC-led government immediately *rejected* the census results. A "recount" was held in 1963, which, unsurprisingly, reversed the figures and gave the **North a large, permanent majority.**
- **Impact:** The census was blatantly rigged. It destroyed any remaining trust between the regions. The NCNC (Igbo leaders) felt betrayed by their NPC coalition partners.

4. THE FEDERAL ELECTION CRISIS (1964):

- The parties realigned into two "grand alliances" for the election:
 - **NNA (Nigerian National Alliance):** The NPC (North) + Akintola's new party (NNDP, West).
 - **UPGA (United Progressive Grand Alliance):** The NCNC (East) + the remnants of the AG (West).
- The election was a farce. It was marked by boycotts, rigging, and violence. The NNA was declared the winner, leading to a constitutional stalemate until Azikiwe (President) and Balewa (PM) agreed to a fragile "broad-based" government.

5. THE "WILD, WILD WEST" ELECTION (1965):

- This was the final nail in the coffin. A regional election was held in the Western Region.
- Akintola's NNDP (allied with the North) was deeply unpopular. The AG (UPGA) was expected to win easily.
- The NNDP massively and openly rigged the election to "win."
- **Impact:** The people of the West rebelled. There was a complete breakdown of law and order. Political opponents were murdered, houses were burned ("Operation

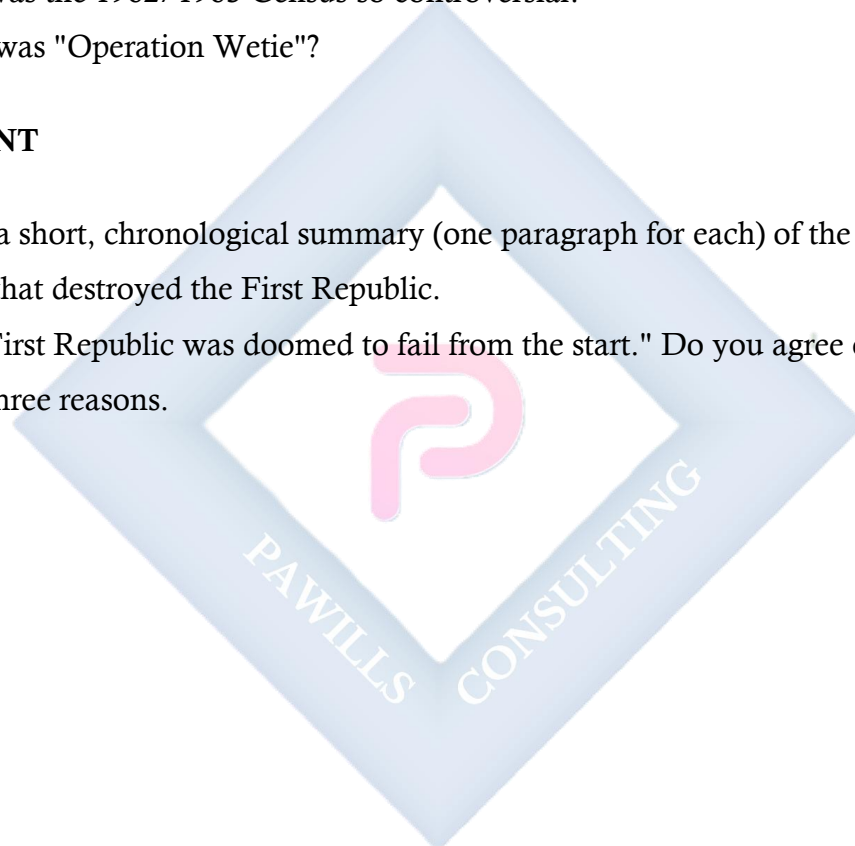
Wetie"). The federal government, led by Balewa, failed to act. It was this chaos that directly led the military to intervene.

EVALUATION

1. When did Nigeria become a full Republic, and who was its first President?
2. What two parties formed the federal government coalition after 1960?
3. Who were the two main figures in the 1962 Action Group Crisis?
4. Why was the 1962/1963 Census so controversial?
5. What was "Operation Wetie"?

ASSIGNMENT

1. Write a short, chronological summary (one paragraph for each) of the five major crises that destroyed the First Republic.
2. "The First Republic was doomed to fail from the start." Do you agree or disagree? Give three reasons.



WEEK 7: MIDTERM BREAK

(This week is for a midterm break. No new lesson notes.)

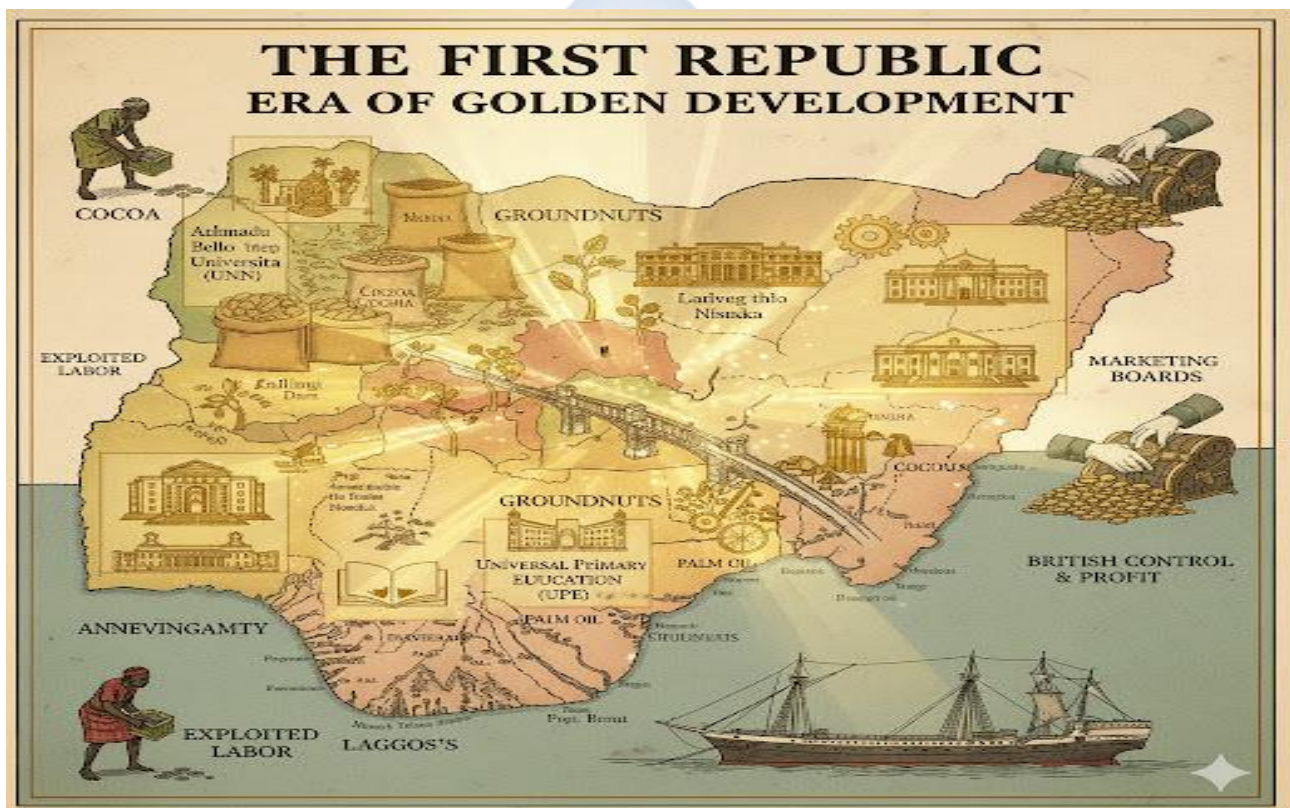


WEEK 8: THE FIRST REPUBLIC: SOCIAL AND ECONOMIC DEVELOPMENTS

8.1 INTRODUCTION

Despite the political chaos, the First Republic was a period of impressive social and economic progress. The three Regions were in fierce competition with each other, leading to a "golden age" of development. This period was funded primarily by **agriculture**, not oil.

Here's an image depicting the period of development and regional competition in Nigeria's First Republic:



8.2 THE ECONOMY

- **AGRICULTURAL BASE:** The economy was still based on the cash crops established by the British. The Regional Marketing Boards (now run by Nigerians) were the main source of government revenue.
 - **North:** Groundnuts, Cotton
 - **West:** Cocoa

- **East: Palm Oil**
- **EARLY OIL INDUSTRY:** Oil had been discovered in commercial quantities at **Oloibiri** (in the Eastern Region) in 1956. By the 1960s, oil was becoming a major export, but it was *not yet* the dominant source of income.
- **NATIONAL DEVELOPMENT PLAN (1962–1968):**
 - This was the first major national plan to guide the economy.
 - It focused on "**Import Substitution Industrialization**" (building Nigerian factories to produce goods that were normally imported, like textiles, cement, and beer).
 - It also funded major infrastructure projects, most notably:
 - **The Kainji Dam** (for nationwide electricity)
 - **The Niger Bridge** (connecting Lagos/West to the East)
 - New ports and roads.

8.3 EDUCATION

This was the "golden age" of Nigerian education, driven by regional competition.

- **WESTERN REGION:** Chief Awolowo's **Universal Primary Education (UPE)** program, launched in 1955, was revolutionary. It made primary education free for all children in the region, leading to a massive boom in literacy.
- **EASTERN AND NORTHERN REGIONS:** They scrambled to catch up, pouring money into building new primary and secondary schools.
- **UNIVERSITY BOOM:**
 - Before 1960, Nigeria had only one university (University College, Ibadan).
 - The Regions, wanting their own "prestige" institutions, established new universities:
 - **University of Nigeria, Nsukka (UNN):** Founded by the Eastern Region (Azikiwe).
 - **Ahmadu Bello University (ABU), Zaria:** Founded by the Northern Region (Ahmadu Bello).

- **University of Ife (now OAU):** Founded by the Western Region (Awolowo).
- The Federal Government also created the **University of Lagos (UNILAG).**

8.4 SOCIAL WELFARE

- **INFRASTRUCTURE:** The regions competed to build symbols of "modernity."
 - **Television:** The Western Region (WNTV) started the **first television station in all of Africa** in 1959.
 - **Stadiums:** Liberty Stadium (Ibadan), Ahmadu Bello Stadium (Kaduna), Nnamdi Azikiwe Stadium (Enugu).
 - **Hospitals:** New general hospitals were built in many towns.
- **NATIONAL PRIDE:** This era saw a new sense of national pride, symbolized by the creation of a new currency (the Nigerian Pound), a new national anthem, a flag, and a national airline (Nigeria Airways).

EVALUATION

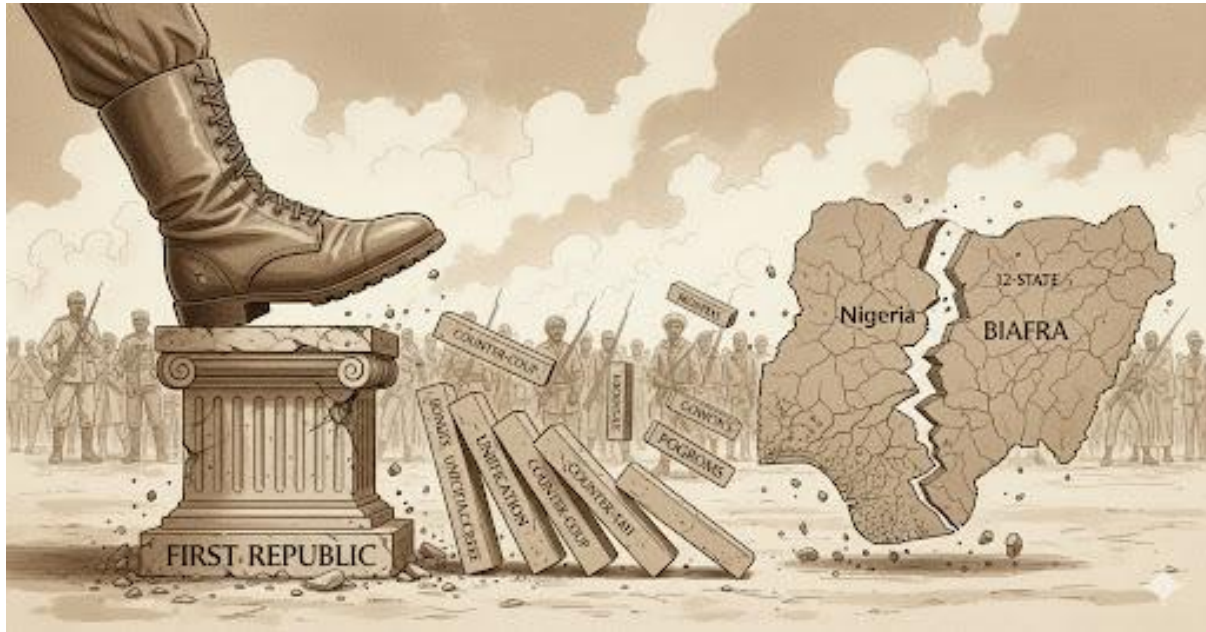
1. What was the main source of government revenue during the First Republic?
2. What was Nigeria's First National Development Plan (1962-68)?
3. Name two major infrastructure projects from this era.
4. What was the UPE scheme, and which region started it?
5. Which was the first television station in Africa?

ASSIGNMENT

1. "The First Republic was a political failure but an economic and social success." Discuss this statement.
2. Research the Kainji Dam. Write one paragraph explaining its purpose and its importance to Nigeria.

WEEK 9: MILITARY INTERVENTION AND THE 1966 COUP

9.1 CAUSES OF THE JANUARY 1966 COUP



By the end of 1965, the First Republic was in a state of total collapse. The military intervened for the following reasons:

1. **"WILD, WILD WEST":** The complete breakdown of law and order in the Western Region, which the Balewa government was unable or unwilling to stop.
2. **BLATANT CORRUPTION:** Politicians were seen as extremely corrupt, enriching themselves at the public's expense.
3. **RIGGED ELECTIONS:** The 1964 and 1965 elections were so badly rigged that they destroyed all faith in democracy.
4. **POLITICIZATION OF THE ARMY:** Politicians had begun to "promote" officers from their own ethnic group, destroying the army's unity and discipline.
5. **FEAR OF IMPLOSION:** The "five majors" who led the coup believed the country was about to disintegrate and that they were acting as "patriots" to save it.

9.2 EVENTS OF THE JANUARY 15, 1966 COUP

- **LEADERS:** A group of young, idealistic, and mostly Igbo officers known as "the five majors." The most prominent was **Major Kaduna Nzeogwu**.
- **GOAL:** To overthrow the "corrupt" politicians, end regionalism, and "cleanse" the nation.
- **EXECUTIONS:** The coup was bloody. The plotters assassinated:
 - **Sir Ahmadu Bello** (Premier of the North)
 - **Sir Abubakar Tafawa Balewa** (Prime Minister)
 - **Chief S.L. Akintola** (Premier of the West)
 - Many high-ranking Northern military officers.
- **FAILURE:** The coup was successful in the North but failed in Lagos. The plotters did not capture the General Officer Commanding (GOC) the army.
- **HANDOVER OF POWER:** The surviving federal ministers, in a state of panic, handed power *not* to the coup plotters, but to the GOC of the Army, **Major-General J.T.U. Aguiyi-Ironsi** (an Igbo), who then became Nigeria's first military Head of State.

9.3 CONSEQUENCES (IRONS'S REGIME AND THE COUNTER-COUP)

1. **AN "IGBO COUP":** The coup was immediately seen as an "Igbo coup."
 - *Why?* The key plotters were Igbo. The politicians and officers killed were almost all from the North or West. The two Igbo premiers (in the East and Mid-West) were spared.
2. **IRONSI'S MISTAKE (UNIFICATION DECREE):**
 - Ironsi's regime, trying to "fix" regionalism, issued **Decree No. 34** in May 1966.
 - This decree **abolished the federal system** and declared Nigeria a "**unitary state**."
 - To the North, this was the final proof that the "Igbo coup" was a plot to allow the more-educated Igbos to dominate the entire country.
3. **THE COUNTER-COUP (JULY 29, 1966):**
 - Northern military officers (led by Lt. Col. Murtala Mohammed) staged a violent "revenge coup."

- Head of State Aguiyi-Ironsi and the Governor of the West were assassinated.
- This coup led to the appointment of a compromise candidate as the new Head of State: **Lt. Col. Yakubu Gowon** (a Northerner, but a Christian from a minority ethnic group).

9.4 THE NIGERIAN CIVIL WAR (1967–1970)

- **PRELUDE (POGROMS):** The July counter-coup was followed by massacres (*pogroms*) of Igbo civilians living in the North. Hundreds of thousands of Igbos fled back to their "homeland" in the East.
- **THE ABURI ACCORD (JANUARY 1967):** Gowon and the military governor of the East, **Lt. Col. Chukwuemeka O. Ojukwu**, met in Aburi, Ghana. They agreed to a "confederal" system (a very weak center), but on returning to Nigeria, they disputed the details.
- **GOWON'S 12-STATE DECREE (MAY 1967):** In a political masterstroke, Gowon broke Nigeria's 4 Regions into 12 States.
 - *Purpose:* To break the power of the major regions and, crucially, to "liberate" the non-Igbo minorities (who lived in the oil-rich areas) from the Eastern Region.
- **SECESSION (MAY 30, 1967):** Ojukwu saw this as the final straw. He declared the Eastern Region an independent nation called the **REPUBLIC OF BIAFRA**.
- **THE WAR:** The Federal Government refused to accept the secession, and war broke out in July 1967. The "police action" turned into a brutal, 30-month (2.5-year) war, marked by a massive federal blockade that led to widespread starvation inside Biafra.
- **THE END:** Biafra surrendered in **January 1970**. Ojukwu fled into exile.

EVALUATION

1. List three main causes of the January 1966 military coup.
2. Who was Major Kaduna Nzeogwu?
3. Why was the January 1966 coup perceived as an "Igbo coup"?
4. What was the Unification Decree No. 34, and why was it so controversial?

5. What was the immediate event that triggered the secession of Biafra in May 1967?

ASSIGNMENT

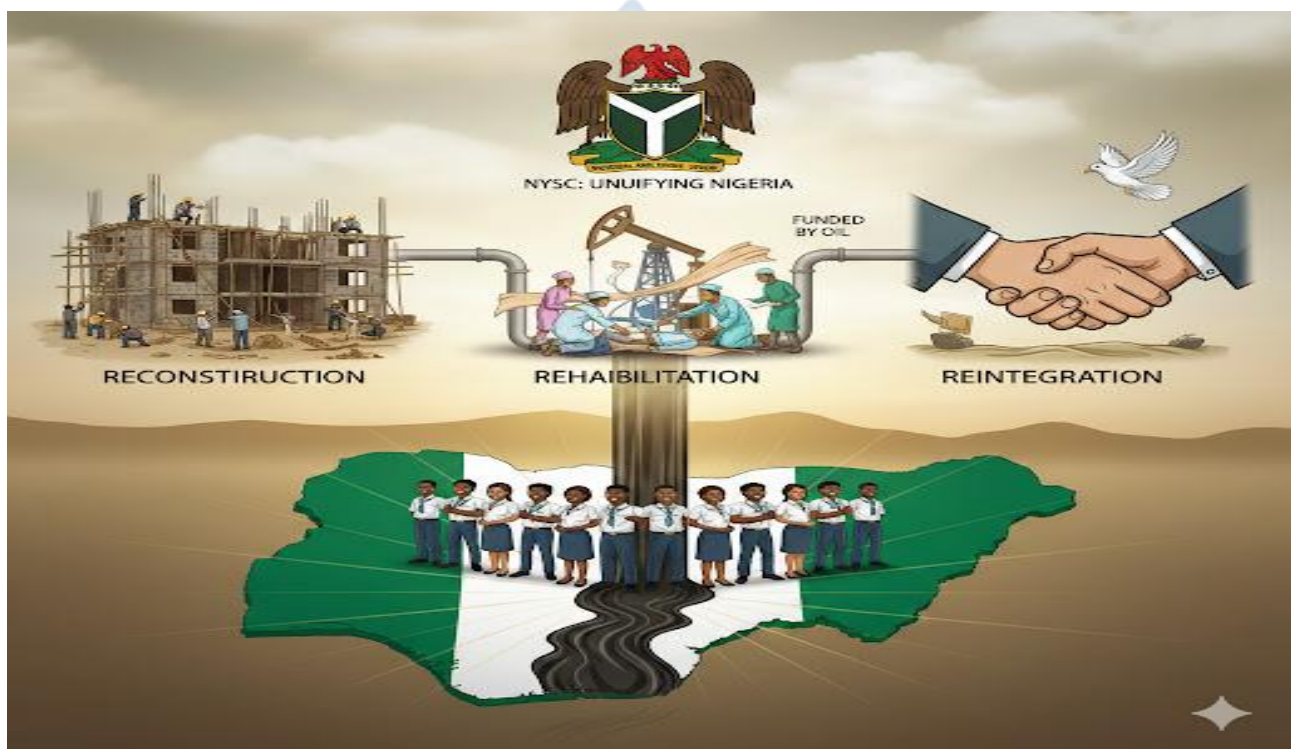
1. "The Nigerian Civil War was not inevitable. It was caused by a series of key mistakes made by leaders on all sides in 1966." Do you agree? Identify two such "mistakes" and explain how they led to war.
2. Create a timeline of the key events of 1966 and 1967 (Jan Coup -> Ironsi -> July Coup -> Gowon -> Aburi -> 12 States -> Secession -> War starts).



WEEK 10: POST-CIVIL WAR NIGERIA

10.1 INTRODUCTION

The Civil War ended in January 1970 with Biafra's surrender. The conflict had devastated the East, killed an estimated 1-2 million people, and left the nation deeply scarred. The immediate post-war period, under the leadership of Yakubu Gowon, was focused on healing.



10.2 GOWON'S "3 RS" POLICY

Gowon declared a policy of **"No Victor, No Vanquished"** to show that the goal was reconciliation, not punishment. This policy was built on "3 Rs":

1. RECONSTRUCTION:

- This involved the physical rebuilding of the war-torn areas (mostly in the East).

- This meant rebuilding bridges (like the Niger Bridge), roads, public buildings, and markets that had been destroyed.

2. **REHABILITATION:**

- This focused on the human side of the war.
- It involved caring for refugees, displaced persons, and demobilizing soldiers.
- It also involved efforts to rehabilitate the economy of the East, for example, by giving a small ex-gratia payment (20 Nigerian pounds) to Igbos to restart their lives, regardless of what they had in the bank before the war.

3. **REINTEGRATION:**

- This was the political and social goal of bringing the Igbo people back into the Nigerian "family."
- Igbo civil servants were re-absorbed into the federal workforce.
- **The "Abandoned Property" Issue:** This was a major challenge. Property left behind by Igbos who fled other parts of the country (especially Port Harcourt) had been seized. A controversial policy was set up to return some of these properties, though many were never recovered.
- **The Indigenization Decree (1972):** This policy (which forced foreigners to sell their businesses to Nigerians) was partly timed to help all Nigerians, including Igbo businessmen, to get a fresh start and buy into the national economy.

10.3 THE ROLE OF THE "OIL BOOM"

All of the "3 Rs" would have been impossible without money. Nigeria was extremely lucky. In the early 1970s, particularly after the 1973 Yom Kippur War, world **oil prices skyrocketed**.

- Nigeria was suddenly flooded with billions of dollars ("petrodollars").
- This "oil boom" paid for the entire 3 Rs program. It funded the rebuilding of the East and massive new national projects.
- Gowon famously said that Nigeria's problem was "not money, but how to spend it."

10.4 OTHER UNITY EFFORTS

Gowon's government launched several other programs to deliberately foster a new sense of national unity and prevent another war.

1. NATIONAL YOUTH SERVICE CORPS (NYSC) (1973):

- This was the most famous unity scheme.
- It made it mandatory for all university graduates to serve for one year in a state *other than their state of origin*.
- **Goal:** To encourage cross-cultural understanding by making a young Yoruba live and work in Sokoto, an Igbo live in Borno, a Hausa live in Calabar, etc.

2. NEW INFRASTRUCTURE:

- The government embarked on building new, unifying infrastructure, such as Federal Highways, to physically link the 12 states.

3. CHANGE TO RIGHT-HAND DRIVE (1972):

- Nigeria (a former British colony) used to drive on the left. In 1972, the country was shut down for a weekend to switch to driving on the **right**.
- **Goal:** A symbolic break with the colonial past and a practical move to align with Nigeria's French-speaking neighbors (Benin, Niger, Cameroon).

4. NATIONAL SPORTS FESTIVAL:

- An "Olympic-style" event created to bring young athletes from all 12 states together in friendly competition.

EVALUATION

1. What was Yakubu Gowon's post-war policy motto?
2. What were the "3 Rs"?
3. What was the "Indigenization Decree" of 1972?
4. What was the "oil boom," and how did it affect the "3 Rs" policy?
5. What is the NYSC, and what was its primary goal?

ASSIGNMENT

1. "Gowon's '3 Rs' policy was a brilliant success and healed the wounds of the Civil War." Critically discuss this statement. Do you think it was a complete success or not?
2. In your opinion, which of the post-war "unity efforts" (NYSC, new highways, sports festival, etc.) was the most important for building a new Nigerian identity? Justify your choice.



WEEK 11: REVISION

(This week is dedicated to a comprehensive review of all topics covered during the third term. Students should review their notes from Weeks 1-10 in preparation for the Third Term Examination.)

- **KEY AREAS FOR REVIEW:**

- **Origins of Nationalism:** The four key causes (Colonial policies, Education, Press, Religion).
- **Nationalist Movements:** The impact of WWII; the "Big Three" parties (NCNC, AG, NPC), their leaders, regions, and goals.
- **Constitutional Development:** The step-by-step progression from Clifford (1922) -> Richards (1946) -> Macpherson (1951) -> Lyttleton (1954), focusing on the key feature of each.
- **Road to Independence:** The 1957/58 conferences, the Willink Commission, the 1959 election, and the foundational challenges of 1960.
- **The First Republic (1960–1966):** The five major crises (AG Crisis, Treason Trial, Census, 1964 Election, 1965 "Wild West").
- **First Republic (Development):** The "golden age" of regional competition; agricultural economy; UPE; and the university boom.
- **1966 and Civil War:** Causes of the Jan coup; the "Igbo coup" perception; Ironsi's Unification Decree; the July counter-coup; Gowon's 12-state decree; Ojukwu's secession of Biafra.
- **Post-War Nigeria:** Gowon's "3 Rs" (Reconstruction, Rehabilitation, Reintegration), the role of the oil boom, and unity efforts like the NYSC.